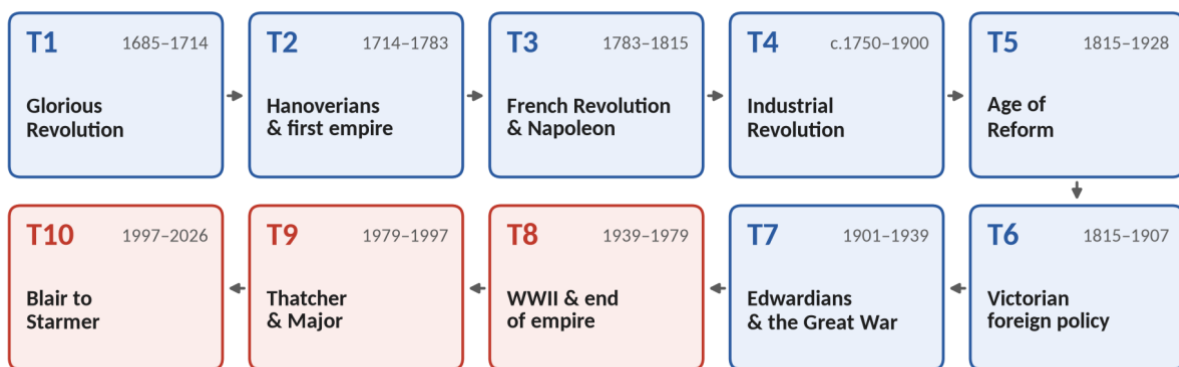


The Master Anatomy

The syllabus, the thirteen papers of 2015–2026, and the plan — the map you read before anything else



Ten topics, told in the order they happened. Every descriptive question (84), every short-note option (21) and every recoverable MCQ (60) set between 2015 and 2026 has been placed, counted and read. Written for a reader who begins knowing **nothing** of British history.

Edition of September 2026 · covers the papers of 2015–2026 and British history from 1685 to 2026

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HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents and page numbers

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How to Use This Document

What this document is

This is **not** a book of British history. It contains very little history. It is the **map** you study before you study — and the map you come back to in the last fortnight, when you have to decide what to revise and what to leave.

It does four jobs:

1. **It explains the paper.** What the syllabus says, how the paper is printed, how many questions you answer, how much time each one gets, and how marks are actually earned.
2. **It dissects the record.** Every descriptive question from **2015 to 2026** (84 full questions and 21 short-note options) and every recoverable MCQ (60 items, 2024–2026) has been tagged by topic, by "family" (the kind of question it is), by syllabus head and by shape. Out of that come the heat map, the repeat engine, the blind spots and the priorities.
3. **It sets up the ten topics.** The fourteen syllabus heads are rebuilt into **ten topics told in time order**, so that the whole paper becomes one continuous story from 1685 to 2026.
4. **It gives you a method and a plan.** How a British History answer is built, how to draw the answer map (mind map) and the sketch maps, and a sixteen-week timetable.

KEY IDEA · The one idea to hold on to

British History is a **story** before it is a syllabus. If you know the story in order — who came before whom, what caused what — every question becomes a matter of choosing the right part of the story and arguing about it. That is why these notes are arranged by **time**, not by the order in which the syllabus happens to list its heads.

Who it is written for

It is written for someone who **does not know the ABC** of British history: who is not sure of the difference between England and Britain, or between a Whig and a Tory, or why a king would need Parliament's permission to raise money. Nothing is assumed.

- Every technical word is explained the first time it appears, and again in the glossary tables of Part Zero.
- Every date that matters is given, and dates you must memorise are printed in **bold teal**, like **1688**.
- Every key term you must be able to define is printed in **bold crimson**, like **constitutional monarchy**.
- The language is deliberately simple. Where a historian's phrase is worth quoting in the exam, it is given in full and explained.

The family of documents

This Master Anatomy is the first of a set. Each of the ten topics then gets **two** Word documents, and when all ten are finished, four combined documents are built from them.

Document	What it contains	When you use it
MA • Master Anatomy (this)	The syllabus, the dissection of 2015–2026, the ten topics, the method, the plan	First; then again in the last fortnight
T1KB ... T10KB • Knowledge Base	The topic told as a story, then broken down: causes, events, results, people, maps, time-lines, historians, one-liner MCQs and a stand-alone revision sheet	While learning each topic
T1QA ... T10QA • Question Answers	Every past question on the topic, fully answered with an answer map, sketch map or figure; every short note; the topic's MCQs solved; at most five predicted questions with outlines	After the Knowledge Base; again before the exam
OL • One-Liner Bank	All the topics' one-liner MCQs combined into one bank	Daily, from the first week
QA print volume	Only the questions and answers from all ten QA documents, nothing else, for printing	For reading on paper, away from the screen
RN • Exam-Night Revision	All ten revision sheets combined, each one complete on its own	The night before the paper
PR • Prediction Papers	Three complete predicted papers with answer plans	The last three weeks

How the pages are built

Every document in the set uses the same page furniture, so that you always know what you are looking at.

What you see	What it means
Heading 1 (navy, underlined in crimson)	A Part or a Chapter. It always starts a new page.
Heading 2 (crimson)	A section inside a chapter, numbered like 2.4.
Heading 3 (teal)	A sub-section.
Heading 4 (blue)	A sub-sub-section — the smallest division.
Crimson bold	A key term you must be able to define in one sentence.
Teal bold	A date, number or name you must memorise exactly.
Coloured boxes	Special material — see the samples below.

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

The **story box** tells a piece of history in the simplest possible words, as you might tell it to a friend. Read these first.

KEY IDEA

The **key idea box** holds the one thought that organises a whole section.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED

The **examiner box** lists where a thing has actually been asked in 2015–2026, so you can see why it matters.

MCQ FACT

The **MCQ fact box** holds a single fact that has been — or could easily be — asked as an objective question.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT

The **trap box** warns you about a mistake candidates commonly make.

VERDICT

The **verdict box** gives a clear judgement you can reproduce in an answer's conclusion.

The reading order

1. Read **Part Zero** slowly. It is the whole of British history from 1685 to 2026 in simple language, with the maps and the monarchs. If you read nothing else today, read that.
2. Read **Parts One to Three** once, quickly. They explain the paper and the record. You do not need to memorise them.
3. Read the **topic dossier** in Part Four for each topic *just before* you begin that topic's Knowledge Base.
4. Read **Part Five** (method) before you write your first practice answer, and again before your first prediction paper.
5. Return to **Part Three** and **Part Six** in the last fortnight to decide what to revise.

Part Zero — British History from Zero

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS · Start here if you know nothing

This Part tells you, in plain words, everything you need **before** the ten topics begin: what the countries are, what the institutions are, what the main words mean, and — in about fifteen minutes of reading — the whole story from 1685 to 2026. Later documents go into detail. This Part gives you the frame to hang the detail on.

0.1 What "British history" means in this paper

The CSS paper is called *British History*, but for most of the period it covers there was no single country called Britain. The paper begins in **1688** with a revolution in **England**; Scotland joins in **1707**, Ireland in **1801**; most of Ireland leaves in **1922**. So the word you use must fit the date you are writing about.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · England, Britain and the UK are not the same thing

Before 1707, write **England** (or "England and Scotland"). From 1707 to 1800, write **Great Britain** or **Britain**. From 1801, write **the United Kingdom** or **Britain**. Examiners notice "Britain in 1688" or "England in 1982" — it tells them you do not know the frame. (The past papers themselves often say "England" loosely; you should not.)

The paper covers three things at once, and every good answer keeps all three in view:

- **Politics at home** — kings and queens, Parliament, parties, Prime Ministers, and how power moved from the Crown to Parliament and then to the voters.
- **Society and economy** — the Agricultural and Industrial Revolutions, towns, religion, workers' movements, the welfare state, Thatcherism, the 2008 crash.
- **Britain and the world** — wars with France, the Empire, the Eastern Question, two World Wars, decolonisation, the Cold War, Europe, the War on Terror, Brexit.

0.2 Four nations and three unions

ENGLAND, BRITAIN, THE UNITED KINGDOM

Four nations, three unions, one partition — the words every answer must use correctly



Figure 1 • The British Isles: the four nations, the capitals, and the places where the story turns. The panel on the right shows how England became Great Britain and then the United Kingdom.

The four nations

- **England** — the largest and richest part, capital **London**. Most of the story happens here, and Parliament sits here at **Westminster**.
- **Scotland** — in the north, capital **Edinburgh**. A separate kingdom until **1707**; it kept its own church (Presbyterian), its own law and its own schools even after union.
- **Wales** — in the west, capital **Cardiff**. Joined to England legally in the 1530s–40s, so for this paper it is almost always treated together with England.
- **Ireland** — the separate island to the west, capital **Dublin**. Mostly **Catholic**, ruled by a **Protestant** landowning class. United with Britain in **1801**; the south left in **1922**; **Northern Ireland** (capital **Belfast**) stayed.

The three unions and the partition

Date	What happened	Why it matters in the paper
1603	Union of the Crowns: James VI of Scotland also becomes James I of England	Two kingdoms, one king, two parliaments — an unstable arrangement
1707	Act of Union: England and Scotland become the Kingdom of Great Britain , with one Parliament	Topic 1. Asked directly in 2021
1801	Act of Union: Great Britain and Ireland become the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland	Topic 3. Asked in 2025 ; MCQ in 2026
1922	Southern Ireland leaves as the Irish Free State; six northern counties stay	Topic 5 and 7. The end of the Irish Question as it stood in the 19th century
1999	Devolution: Scottish Parliament, Welsh Assembly (now Senedd), Northern Ireland Assembly	Topic 10. Part of Blair's constitutional reforms

0.3 The words you must know before anything else

These words appear on almost every page of every topic. Learn them now; each Knowledge Base repeats and deepens them.

Word	What it means, simply
The Crown / monarch	The king or queen. In 1688 the monarch still chose ministers and ran the government; by 1900 the monarch reigned but did not rule.
Parliament	The law-making body at Westminster: the monarch, the House of Lords and the House of Commons together.
House of Commons	The elected house. It controls money (taxes). Over the whole period it becomes the centre of power.
House of Lords	The unelected upper house of nobles and bishops. Its power was cut by the Parliament Act of 1911 .
Prime Minister	The head of the government. The first is usually taken to be Robert Walpole (1721–1742) . The PM governs because he or she commands a majority in the Commons.
Cabinet	The group of senior ministers who decide policy together under the Prime Minister.
Constitutional monarchy	A system where the monarch is head of state but must govern through ministers responsible to Parliament. Born in 1688–89 .
Divine right of kings	The belief that kings are appointed by God and answer only to God. The Stuarts believed it; 1688 ended it.

Word	What it means, simply
Whig	The party that supported the Glorious Revolution, the Protestant Hanoverian kings, and Parliament's power. Later becomes the Liberal Party.
Tory	The party of the Crown, the Church of England and the landed gentry. Later becomes the Conservative Party (from the 1830s, under Peel).
Labour Party	Founded 1900 (as the Labour Representation Committee) to put working men into Parliament. Replaces the Liberals as the main rival of the Conservatives after 1918–1924.
Protestant / Catholic	The two great divisions of Western Christianity. England's official church (the Church of England) is Protestant; a Catholic king in the 1680s terrified most of the political class.
Dissenters / Nonconformists	Protestants outside the Church of England (Baptists, Quakers, later Methodists). Tolerated after 1689 but kept out of public office until 1828 .
Jacobite	A supporter of the exiled Catholic Stuart line (from <i>Jacobus</i> , Latin for James). They rose in 1715 and 1745 .
Franchise	The right to vote. Widened by the Reform Acts of 1832 , 1867 , 1884 , 1918 and 1928 .
Rotten borough	A constituency with almost no voters that still elected MPs — a symbol of the unreformed Parliament before 1832.
Empire / colony / Dominion	The Empire is all the lands ruled from London. A colony is ruled directly. A Dominion (Canada 1867, Australia 1901, New Zealand 1907, South Africa 1910) is self-governing.
Commonwealth	The free association of Britain and its former colonies. Its modern form dates from the London Declaration of 1949 .
Free trade / protection	Free trade means no taxes on imports; protection means tariffs to shield home producers. The great Victorian argument, decided for free trade by the repeal of the Corn Laws in 1846 .
Splendid Isolation	Britain's late-Victorian policy of avoiding permanent alliances. Abandoned between 1902 and 1907 .
Appeasement	Avoiding war by giving in to reasonable-looking demands — Chamberlain's policy towards Hitler, ending at Munich in 1938 .
Welfare state	The system of state benefits, free health care (NHS 1948) and social insurance built by Attlee's Labour government.
Decolonisation	The process by which the colonies became independent — mostly between 1947 and the late 1960s.
Thatcherism	Margaret Thatcher's mix of free markets, privatisation, curbing trade unions, low inflation and a strong state (1979–1990).
New Labour	Tony Blair's re-branded Labour Party (1994 onwards): market economy plus social investment — the "Third Way".
Brexit	Britain's exit from the European Union: referendum 23 June 2016 , departure 31 January 2020 .

0.4 The whole story in fifteen minutes

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS · Read this as one continuous story

Each paragraph below is one of the ten topics, in order. The detail comes later. For now, just follow the thread: **power moves from the Crown to Parliament, then from Parliament to the people; Britain rises to world power through war, trade and industry; then the Empire ends and Britain searches for a new role.**

Topic 1 · 1685–1714 · The Glorious Revolution and the later Stuarts

In **1685 James II**, a Catholic, became king of a Protestant country. He tried to give Catholics equal rights by royal command (the **Declarations of Indulgence**), appointed Catholics to the army and universities, and in **1688** his wife gave birth to a Catholic son. Leading politicians invited his Protestant son-in-law, **William of Orange**, ruler of the Dutch Republic, to invade. William landed at Torbay on **5 November 1688**; James's support collapsed and he fled to France. Parliament gave the crown jointly to **William III and Mary II** and passed the **Bill of Rights (1689)**: the monarch could no longer suspend laws, raise taxes or keep an army in peacetime without Parliament. This was the **Glorious Revolution** — "glorious" because it was almost bloodless in England and because it settled for ever that the Crown rules under Parliament. William took England into his wars against **Louis XIV** of France (the Nine Years' War, ended by the **Treaty of Ryswick, 1697**). Queen **Anne (1702–1714)** fought the **War of the Spanish Succession**, won by the Duke of **Marlborough** at **Blenheim (1704)** and ended by the **Treaty of Utrecht (1713)**, which gave Britain Gibraltar and a place among the great powers. In **1707** the **Act of Union** joined England and Scotland into **Great Britain**. The **Act of Settlement (1701)** had already fixed that the crown would pass to the Protestant House of **Hanover**.

Topic 2 · 1714–1783 · Hanoverians, Whigs and the first empire

In **1714 George I**, a German prince, became king. The Tories were suspected of favouring the exiled Stuarts, so the **Whigs** ruled for almost fifty years — the **Whig oligarchy**. Their greatest leader, **Sir Robert Walpole (1721–1742)**, is counted as the first Prime Minister: he kept the peace, kept taxes low and managed Parliament through patronage ("let sleeping dogs lie"). The exiled Stuarts tried twice to return — the **Jacobite rebellions** of **1715** and **1745**; the second, led by "Bonnie Prince" **Charles Edward Stuart**, reached Derby before being crushed at **Culloden (1746)**. Meanwhile Britain built an empire of trade based on the **Old Colonial System** (mercantilism: colonies exist to enrich the mother country), on sugar islands in the Caribbean, and on the **Atlantic slave trade**. Under **William Pitt the Elder** (later Lord Chatham) Britain won the **Seven Years' War (1756–1763)**: Canada from France, dominance in India after **Plassey (1757)**. But the cost led Parliament to tax the American colonists, who had no MPs — "no taxation without representation". The **American War of Independence (1775–1783)** ended with the **Treaty of Paris (1783)** and the loss of thirteen colonies under **George III** and **Lord North**.

Topic 3 · 1783–1815 · Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and Ireland

The young **William Pitt** became Prime Minister at 24 in **1783** and rebuilt the nation's finances. Then in **1789** the **French Revolution** overthrew the French monarchy. At first many Britons cheered; then came the Terror, the execution of Louis XVI, and war (from **1793**). Frightened of revolution at home, Pitt's government suspended *habeas corpus*, banned "seditious" meetings and outlawed trade unions (the **Combination Acts**, 1799–1800). Edmund **Burke** attacked the Revolution; Thomas **Paine** defended it — the great argument of the age. In **1798** Ireland rose in rebellion with French help; Pitt's answer was the **Act of Union** (**1801**), abolishing the Irish Parliament and creating the **United Kingdom**. The war against **Napoleon** was won at sea by **Nelson** at **Trafalgar** (**1805**) and on land by **Wellington** in Spain and finally at **Waterloo** (**18 June 1815**). The **Congress of Vienna** (**1815**) redrew Europe and left Britain the world's leading power.

Topic 4 · c.1750–1900 · The Industrial and Agricultural Revolutions and the new society

Across the same years, Britain's economy changed as no economy had before. **Enclosure** and new farming methods (the **Agricultural Revolution**) fed a growing population and pushed labourers off the land. Coal, iron, steam power (**James Watt's** engine, patented **1769**), canals, cotton factories and, after **1830**, railways created the **Industrial Revolution**. Britain became "the workshop of the world". New towns like **Manchester** grew fast and filthy; children worked in mills; wages and hours were brutal. New ideas and movements answered this new world: **Methodism** (founded by **John Wesley** from the **1730s**), which brought religion to the poor; **Utilitarianism** (**Jeremy Bentham**: "the greatest happiness of the greatest number"); **Liberalism** (free trade, individual liberty); **Socialism** (**Robert Owen**, later the **Fabian Society**, **1884**); and **Chartism** (**1838–1848**), a mass movement demanding votes for all men, which failed at the time but whose demands were almost all granted later.

Topic 5 · 1815–1928 · The Age of Reform, the parties and Ireland

After 1815 the unreformed Parliament faced angry demands for change — the **Peterloo** massacre in Manchester (**1819**) showed how brutal the old order could be. The Tories under **Lord Liverpool**, then **Canning** and **Wellington**, reformed slowly (Catholic Emancipation, **1829**). The Whigs under **Earl Grey** passed the **Great Reform Act** (**1832**), abolishing rotten boroughs and giving the vote to the middle class; the short reign of **William IV** (**1830–1837**) saw a flood of reforms (abolition of slavery in the Empire, **1833**; the Factory Act, **1833**; the New Poor Law, **1834**; municipal reform, **1835**). **Sir Robert Peel** turned the Tories into the **Conservative Party** (Tamworth Manifesto, **1834**) and, as Prime Minister (**1841–1846**), repealed the **Corn Laws** (**1846**) during the Irish **Famine** — splitting his party. Out of that split came the modern two-party system: **Gladstone's** Liberals against **Disraeli's** Conservatives. Further Reform Acts (**1867**, **1884**) gave the vote to working men; secret ballot came in **1872**. Gladstone's great mission was Ireland — disestablishing the Irish Church (**1869**), land acts, and two failed **Home Rule** Bills (**1886**, **1893**). Women over 30 won the vote in **1918**, and on equal terms with men in **1928**.

Topic 6 · 1815–1907 · Victorian Britain and the world

Abroad, Britain's aim was simple: keep the **balance of power** in Europe, protect the sea routes to **India**, and trade freely everywhere. **Lord Palmerston** (Foreign Secretary and later Prime Minister) defended British interests aggressively — "gunboat diplomacy" and the **Don Pacifico** affair (**1850**). The **Eastern Question** — what should happen as the **Ottoman Empire** weakened, and how to stop Russia gaining from it — produced the **Crimean War** (**1854–1856**) and, under **Disraeli**, the **Congress of Berlin** (**1878**), from which he returned claiming "peace with honour". Disraeli bought shares in the **Suez Canal** (**1875**) and made Victoria **Empress of India** (**1876**). Late in the century Britain joined the **Scramble for Africa** and fought the **Boer War** (**1899–1902**). Under **Lord Salisbury** Britain stood apart from Europe's alliances — **Splendid Isolation** — until the rise of Germany ended it: the **Anglo-Japanese Alliance** (**1902**), the **Entente Cordiale** with France (**1904**) and the **Anglo-Russian Convention** (**1907**).

Topic 7 · 1901–1939 · Edwardian Britain, the Great War and the road to 1939

Edward VII (**1901–1910**) gave his name to a short, confident age. The **Liberal** governments of **Campbell-Bannerman** and **Asquith** (from **1905**) laid the foundations of the welfare state (old-age pensions **1908**, National Insurance **1911**) and, after **Lloyd George's** "People's Budget", cut the power of the Lords (**Parliament Act, 1911**). The new **Labour Party** won 29 seats in **1906**. Then Europe went to war: Britain declared war on Germany on **4 August 1914** after the invasion of Belgium. The **First World War** killed about 750,000 British servicemen, brought conscription, women into factories and the vote for women, and destroyed the Liberal Party, which split between Asquith and Lloyd George. The **Treaty of Versailles** (**28 June 1919**) and the **League of Nations** were meant to prevent another war. They did not. After the **Great Depression** (**1929** onwards) and the rise of Hitler, **Neville Chamberlain** tried **appeasement**, culminating in the **Munich Agreement** (**1938**), while rearming — until Germany invaded Poland and Britain declared war on **3 September 1939**.

Topic 8 · 1939–1979 · The Second World War, Attlee, the Cold War and the end of empire

Winston Churchill led Britain from **May 1940** through Dunkirk, the **Battle of Britain** and the **Blitz** to victory in **1945** in alliance with the USA and the USSR; the wartime conferences (Tehran, Yalta, Potsdam) and the **United Nations** (**1945**) shaped the post-war world. Voters then chose **Clement Attlee's** Labour government (**1945–1951**), which built the **welfare state** and the **NHS** (**1948**) and nationalised coal, rail and the Bank of England. The **Cold War** divided the world; Britain helped found **NATO** (**1949**) and kept a "special relationship" with the USA. The Empire ended: India and Pakistan became independent in **August 1947**; Britain left Palestine in **1948**; the **Suez Crisis** (**1956**) showed that Britain could no longer act against American wishes; Macmillan's "**wind of change**" speech (**1960**) signalled the end in Africa. Britain turned to Europe, was vetoed twice by France (1963, 1967), and joined the **EEC** in **1973**. The 1970s brought inflation, strikes and the "**Winter of Discontent**" (**1978–79**) under **James Callaghan**.

Topic 9 • 1979–1997 • Thatcher and Major

Margaret Thatcher, Britain's first woman Prime Minister (1979–1990), set out to reverse decline: she fought inflation, cut the power of the trade unions (defeating the **miners' strike, 1984–85**), privatised state industries, sold council houses and freed the City of London. She won the **Falklands War** against Argentina (1982) and stood with Reagan in the last years of the Cold War, while fighting Brussels over money and sovereignty. Her own party removed her in 1990 over Europe and the poll tax. **John Major** (1990–1997) signed the **Maastricht Treaty** (1992) that created the **European Union**, won a surprise election in 1992, then lost authority after "**Black Wednesday**" (Britain forced out of the ERM, 16 September 1992) and party splits over Europe, losing heavily in 1997.

Topic 10 • 1997–2026 • Blair to Burnham

Tony Blair's New Labour won a landslide in 1997: Bank of England independence, devolution to Scotland and Wales, the **Good Friday Agreement** in Northern Ireland (1998), the minimum wage and the Human Rights Act. After the attacks of 11 September 2001 Blair stood "shoulder to shoulder" with the USA in Afghanistan (2001) and Iraq (2003) — the **War on Terror** — and London suffered the 7/7 bombings (2005). **Gordon Brown** (2007–2010) faced the 2008 global financial crisis. **David Cameron** led a Conservative–Liberal Democrat coalition (2010–2015) that imposed austerity, then called the **EU referendum**, which Leave won on 23 June 2016. **Theresa May** and **Boris Johnson** negotiated **Brexit** (left the EU 31 January 2020); Johnson led through the COVID-19 pandemic; **Elizabeth II** died in September 2022 and **Charles III** succeeded; **Liz Truss** lasted 49 days; **Rishi Sunak** steadied the finances; and **Keir Starmer** won a Labour landslide on 4 July 2024.

0.5 Who reigned — and which topic you are in

WHO REIGNED — AND WHICH TOPIC YOU ARE IN

Fifteen reigns, four royal houses, ten topics: the whole paper on one time-line

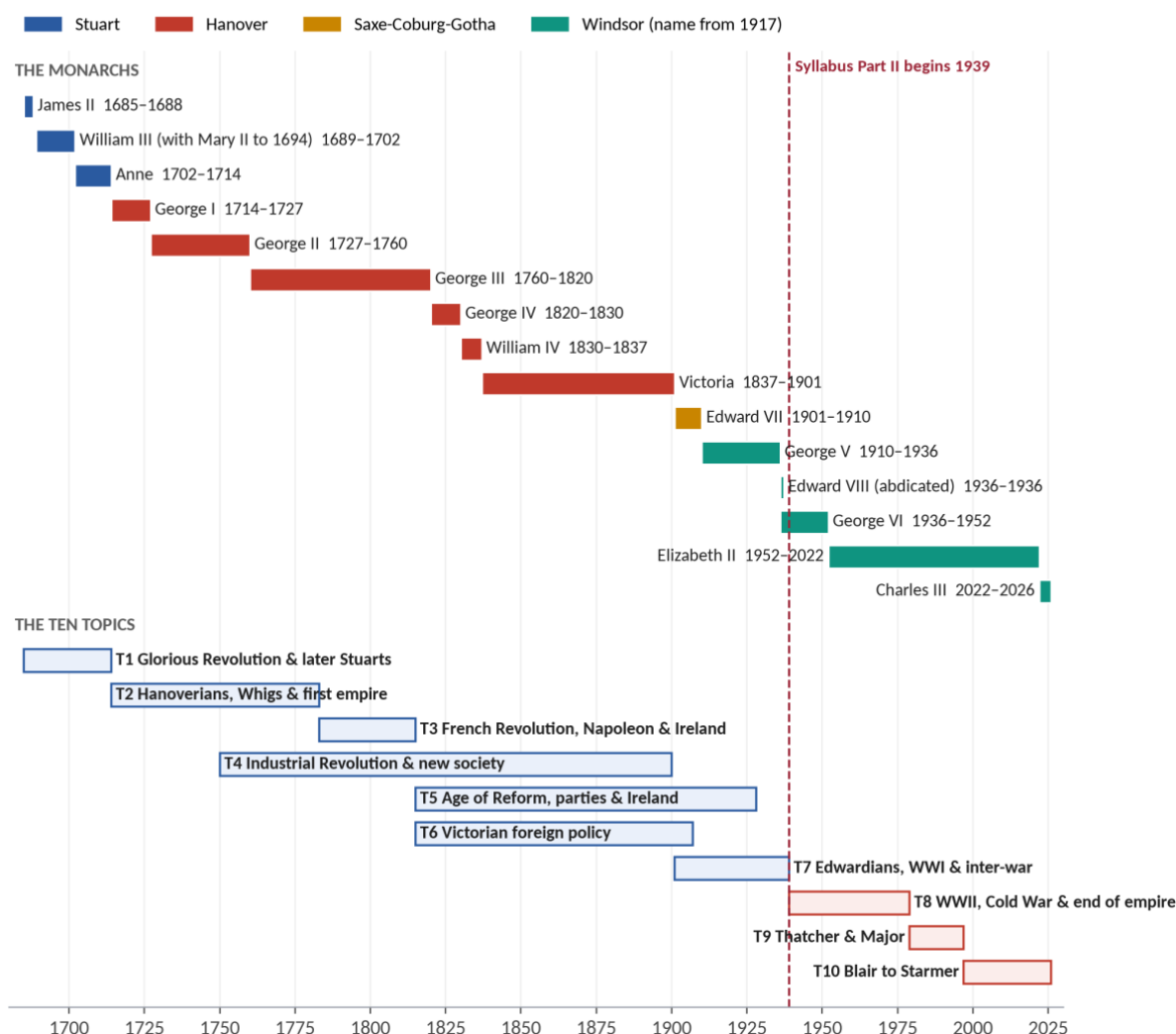


Figure 2 • The fifteen reigns from James II to Charles III, coloured by royal house, set against the ten topics. The dashed line at 1939 is where the syllabus divides into Part I and Part II.

MCQ FACT • Monarch facts that have been asked

Mary II ruled jointly with William III (2026). The **Act of Settlement 1701** secured the crown for **Hanover** (2026). **George III** was king during the American war (2024). The longest-reigning Hanoverian was **Victoria**, 63 years (2024 — the options were wrong, so the answer was "None of these"). **Edward VII** gave the Edwardian era its name (2025). **Edward VIII** abdicated on **11 December 1936** (2024). **Elizabeth II** was crowned on **2 June 1953** (2024).

The Prime Ministers you will meet

You do not need every Prime Minister. You do need these, with their party and their dates, because the questions are built around them.

Prime Minister	Party	In office	Why he or she matters (topic)
Sir Robert Walpole	Whig	1721–1742	First "Prime Minister"; peace, low taxes, patronage (T2)
William Pitt the Elder (Earl of Chatham)	Whig	war leader 1756–61; PM 1766–68	Won the Seven Years' War (T2)
Lord North	Tory	1770–1782	Lost America (T2)
William Pitt the Younger	Tory	1783–1801, 1804–06	Finances, war with France, Union with Ireland (T3)
Lord Liverpool	Tory	1812–1827	Repression after 1815, then "liberal Tory" reform (T5)
George Canning	Tory	1827	Liberal Tory foreign policy (T5, T6)
Duke of Wellington	Tory	1828–1830	Victor of Waterloo; Catholic Emancipation 1829 (T3, T5)
Earl Grey	Whig	1830–1834	Great Reform Act 1832 (T5)
Sir Robert Peel	Conservative	1834–35, 1841–46	Modern Conservatism; Corn Law repeal 1846 (T5)
Lord Palmerston	Whig/Liberal	1855–58, 1859–65	Foreign Secretary for 15 years; gunboat diplomacy (T6)
Benjamin Disraeli	Conservative	1868, 1874–1880	1867 Reform Act; Suez shares; Berlin 1878 (T5, T6)
William Ewart Gladstone	Liberal	1868–74, 1880–85, 1886, 1892–94	Peace, retrenchment, reform; Irish Home Rule (T5, T6)
Lord Salisbury	Conservative	1885–1902 (three terms)	Splendid Isolation (T6)
H. H. Asquith	Liberal	1908–1916	Liberal reforms, Parliament Act 1911, war (T7)
David Lloyd George	Liberal	1916–1922	War leader, Versailles (T7)
Neville Chamberlain	Conservative	1937–1940	Appeasement, Munich (T7)
Winston Churchill	Conservative	1940–45, 1951–55	War leader (T8)
Clement Attlee	Labour	1945–1951	Welfare state, NHS, Indian independence (T8)
Anthony Eden	Conservative	1955–1957	Suez (T8)
Harold Macmillan	Conservative	1957–1963	"Wind of change"; first EEC application (T8)
Harold Wilson	Labour	1964–70, 1974–76	1975 EEC referendum (T8)
Edward Heath	Conservative	1970–1974	Took Britain into the EEC, 1973 (T8)
James Callaghan	Labour	1976–1979	IMF loan; Winter of Discontent (T8)
Margaret Thatcher	Conservative	1979–1990	Thatcherism, Falklands (T9)
John Major	Conservative	1990–1997	Maastricht, 1992 win, 1997 defeat (T9)
Tony Blair	Labour	1997–2007	New Labour, Iraq (T10)
Gordon Brown	Labour	2007–2010	2008 financial crisis (T10)
David Cameron	Conservative	2010–2016	Coalition, austerity, EU referendum (T10)

Prime Minister	Party	In office	Why he or she matters (topic)
Theresa May	Conservative	2016–2019	Brexit negotiations (T10)
Boris Johnson	Conservative	2019–2022	"Get Brexit done"; COVID-19 (T10)
Liz Truss	Conservative	Sept–Oct 2022	Mini-budget crisis; shortest-serving PM (T10)
Rishi Sunak	Conservative	2022–2024	First British Asian PM; lost 2024 election (T10)
Sir Keir Starmer	Labour	2024–	Labour landslide of 4 July 2024 (T10)

MCQ FACT • Prime-minister facts that have been asked

The **longest-serving** PM was **Walpole** (2024). **Two** PMs served during the First World War: **Asquith** and **Lloyd George** (2024). **Major** succeeded **Thatcher** (2024). **Lord North** was PM at the American Declaration of Independence (2026). **Callaghan** was PM during the Winter of Discontent (2026). **Peel** repealed the Corn Laws (2025). The 2010–15 coalition was led by **Cameron** (2026), with the **Liberal Democrats** (2026).

0.6 The syllabus on one map

THE SYLLABUS ON ONE MAP

Eighteen places that recur across the ten topics — numbers are keyed in the table below

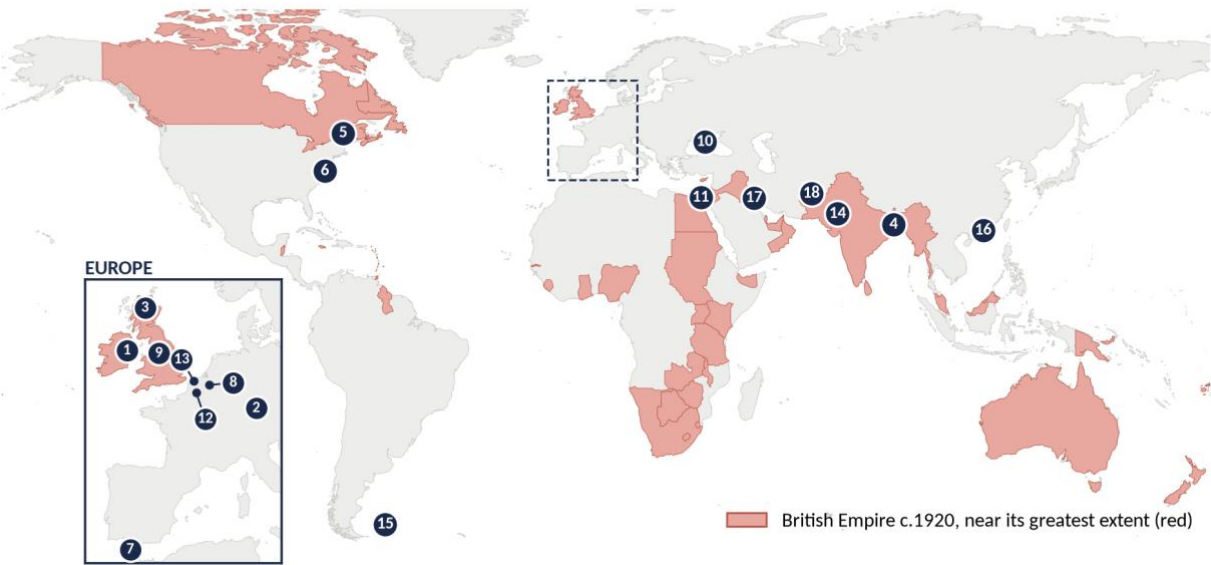


Figure 3 • The British Empire around 1920 (shaded red) with eighteen places that recur across the ten topics. The dashed box on the main map is enlarged as the Europe inset.

#	Place	Year	Topic	What happened there
1	The Boyne (Ireland)	1690	T1	William III defeats James II; Protestant rule in Ireland secured
2	Blenheim (Bavaria)	1704	T1	Marlborough's great victory in the War of the Spanish Succession

#	Place	Year	Topic	What happened there
3	Culloden (Scotland)	1746	T2	The last Jacobite rising crushed; last pitched battle on British soil
4	Plassey (Bengal)	1757	T2	Clive's victory; the East India Company begins to rule India
5	Quebec (Canada)	1759	T2	Wolfe takes Quebec; Canada won from France
6	Yorktown (Virginia)	1781	T2	British surrender; the American war is lost
7	Trafalgar (off Spain)	1805	T3	Nelson destroys the French and Spanish fleets
8	Waterloo (Belgium)	1815	T3	Wellington and Blücher defeat Napoleon
9	Manchester	1819	T4 · T5	Cotton capital of the Industrial Revolution; Peterloo massacre
10	Sevastopol (Crimea)	1854–55	T6	Siege at the heart of the Crimean War
11	Suez Canal (Egypt)	1869 / 1956	T6 · T8	Route to India; Disraeli's shares 1875; the crisis of 1956
12	The Somme (France)	1916	T7	57,470 British casualties on the first day, 1 July 1916
13	Dunkirk (France)	1940	T8	Evacuation of 338,000 troops (Operation Dynamo)
14	Delhi and Karachi	1947	T8	Independence and partition of India and Pakistan
15	Falkland Islands	1982	T9	Argentine invasion defeated
16	Hong Kong	1997	T10	Handed back to China — the symbolic end of empire
17	Basra (Iraq)	2003	T10	British sector in the Iraq War
18	Helmand (Afghanistan)	2006–14	T10	Main British combat mission of the War on Terror

0.7 Five habits of mind for a history paper

- 1. Always know the date.** A British History answer without dates is an opinion. Put a date in almost every sentence of your evidence.
- 2. Always ask "why then?"** Events have causes. Every answer should explain why something happened *when* it did — not earlier, not later.
- 3. Always see both sides.** The examiner rewards balance: the case for, the case against, and your verdict.
- 4. Always connect.** The Glorious Revolution explains the Hanoverians; the French Revolution explains the repression of 1815–1819; the Industrial Revolution explains Chartism and Labour; the World Wars explain decolonisation. Link backwards and forwards.
- 5. Always answer the question that was set.** Not the question you prepared. The single most common failure in this paper is a good essay on the wrong question.

Part One — The Paper Itself

1.1 Where British History sits in CSS

The CSS written examination has 600 marks of compulsory papers and 600 marks of optional papers. The optional subjects are arranged in groups. **British History** is in **Group IV**, the history group, where you may choose **one** subject of 100 marks from five:

Code	Subject
26	History of Pakistan & India
27	Islamic History & Culture
28	British History
29	European History
30	History of USA

So British History is always **one paper of 100 marks**. It was not always so: until 2015 it was examined in **two** papers (Paper I and Paper II), which is why the 2015 record in this document has two sets of questions. From **2016** the revised syllabus ("CE-2016 and onwards") made it a single paper.

KEY IDEA · Why candidates choose it — and why it rewards the prepared

British History overlaps heavily with other papers you already sit: **Current Affairs** and **Pakistan Affairs** (partition, the Commonwealth, the War on Terror), **International Relations** and **Political Science** (the British constitution, the Cold War, the EU), and even the **Essay** (empire, democracy, reform). Its syllabus is a single continuous story, which makes it easier to learn in order than a subject of scattered heads. And its questions repeat — as Part Three shows — more predictably than in most optional papers.

1.2 The syllabus, word for word

This is the syllabus exactly as FPSC published it for CE-2016 and onwards. It has **fourteen heads**, divided into **Part I (50 marks)** and **Part II (50 marks)**. The spelling "Chartest", "Torries" and "Cameroun" is FPSC's own.

Head	Title	Sub-heads as printed
Part I	(Marks 50)	
I	The Glorious Revolution (1688)	Causes, and Results · William III and Mary II (1689–1702) · Queen Anne (1702–1714)
II	Hanoverian Era (1714–1790)	Jacobite Rebellions (1715 and 1745) · Robert Walpole and Whig Oligarchy · American War of Independence (1776)
III	The Union of England and Scotland	—

Head	Title	Sub-heads as printed
IV	Union of England and Ireland	—
V	The Old Colonial System	—
VI	The French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars	Causes · Britain and Napoleonic Wars · Impact on Britain
VII	Industrial and Agricultural Revolution	Causes · Effects on Political and Social Life of Britain · Party Politics · The Methodist Movement · Socialism · Liberalism · Colonization · Chartest Movement
VIII	Robert Peel and return of Tories	Internal policies · Irish Problem
IX	Victorian Era (1837–1901)	Internal Reforms · Liberals · Foreign Policy · Disraeli, Gladstone and Problems in Ireland · Great Britain and Free Trade
X	Edwardian Era (1901–1910)	Domestic and Foreign Policies (1901–1910) · The Origins of Labor Party
XI	Britain, World War I and its Aftermath	Causes · Britain and Peace settlement · Effects of War on Britain · League of Nations · The Great Depression · Appeasement and Rearmament
Part II	(Marks 50)	
XII	Britain, World War II and its Aftermath	Causes and events · Churchill, War Conferences · Creation of U.N.O · Effects of war · Reforms of Labour Government
XIII	Great Britain and Cold War	Creation of Common Wealth · NATO · Decolonization of the British Empire · Internal Policies and EEC · Foreign Policy
XIV	Thatcherism to Cameron (1979–2012)	Internal Policy · Society and culture · Foreign Policy · Falkland War · John Major and his Policies · European Common Market and the Great Britain · Formation of EU · Tony Blair "New Labour" Economic Crunch, War on Terror and his Policies · Global Financial Crisis 2008 and the Great Britain · Reforms under Cameroun

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · Three things the syllabus's wording hides

First, Part I (eleven heads, 1688–1939) and Part II (three heads, 1939–2012) carry **equal marks** — so three heads are worth as much as eleven. **Second**, heads III, IV and V carry **no dates** and sit out of time order; this is why these notes rebuild the heads into ten topics told chronologically (Part Two). **Third**, the syllabus stops at **2012**, but the examiner does not: Brexit (2016) was asked in **2017**, Cameron's reforms in **2024** and **2025**. These notes therefore run to **2026**.

1.3 The suggested readings — which ones actually help

FPSC lists fifteen books. You cannot read them all, and some are hard to find. Here is an honest guide to what each is good for.

Book (as listed)	Covers	Verdict for a CSS candidate
Norman Lowe, <i>Mastering Modern British History</i>	1760s–2000s	The single most useful book. Clear, exam-shaped chapters. Use it as your main text for T4–T10.
E. H. Carter (and R. A. F. Mears), <i>A History of Britain</i>	Whole period	The classic school text; strong for T1–T3 narrative.
G. W. Southgate, <i>A Textbook of Modern English History 1714–1960</i>	1714–1960	Old but very exam-friendly; excellent for T2–T8.
V. H. H. Green, <i>The Hanoverians, 1714–1815</i>	1714–1815	Good depth on Walpole, Chatham and George III (T2–T3).
Robert Blake, <i>The Conservative Party from Peel to Thatcher</i>	1830–1980s	The source for Peel, Disraeli and Conservatism (T5, T9).
Michael Bentley, <i>Politics without Democracy: Great Britain 1815–1914</i> (listed as "Democracy: Great Britain 1815–1914")	1815–1914	For the reform acts and parties (T5).
David Thomson, <i>Europe since Napoleon</i>	1815–1950s	For the Eastern Question and alliances (T6, T7).
A. J. P. Taylor, <i>The Struggle for Mastery in Europe 1848–1918</i>	1848–1918	For Crimea, Berlin and Splendid Isolation (T6).
A. J. P. Taylor, <i>English History 1914–1945</i>	1914–1945	Brilliant, quotable; for T7–T8.
Kenneth O. Morgan, <i>The People's Peace: British History 1945–1990</i>	1945–1990	For Attlee to Thatcher (T8–T9).
Chris Cook and John Ramsden (eds), <i>Trends in British Politics since 1945</i>	1945–1970s	Useful essays; secondary.
L. J. Butler, <i>Britain and Empire</i>	1945 onwards	The book for decolonisation (T8).
G. M. Trevelyan, <i>English Social History</i>	Social history	For the Industrial Revolution and Methodism (T4).
<i>A New History of England, 410–1975</i> (Pergamon, 1968)	Whole period	Reference only.
W. T. Selley, <i>England in the Eighteenth Century</i>	18th century	For T1–T2 detail.

NOTE · Where the books stop

None of the listed books covers the period after about 2000 in depth. For T10 (Blair to Burnham) you need newer material; the T10 documents in this set are written from current sources to 2026.

1.4 How the paper is built

THE ANATOMY OF THE PAPER

Four answers of 20 marks — two from each section — plus twenty objective items

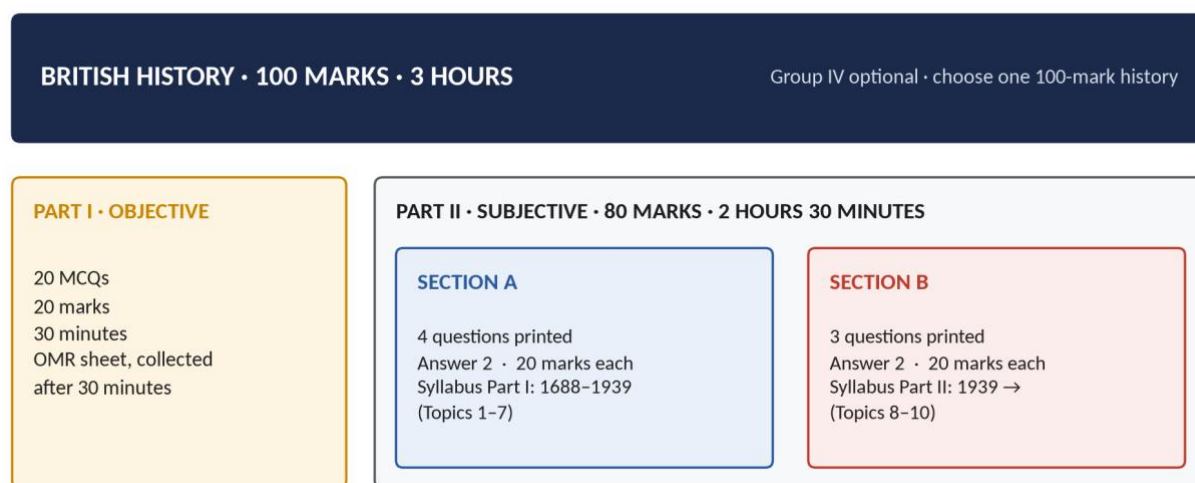


Figure 4 • The anatomy of the paper since 2016: twenty objective items, then four descriptive answers — two from each section.

Part I — the objective questions

- **Twenty MCQs**, one mark each, **20 marks** in all.
- **Thirty minutes**, on a separate **OMR** answer sheet that is collected when the thirty minutes end.
- Options are always A, B, C and **D "None of these"** — and D is the right answer surprisingly often (Part 3.8).

Part II — the descriptive questions

- **80 marks, 2 hours 30 minutes**.
- Seven questions are printed: **Section A** carries four (drawn from syllabus Part I) and **Section B** carries three (drawn from syllabus Part II).
- You attempt **four** questions, **two from each section**. All questions carry **equal marks** — 20 each. A short-notes question counts as one question: you write two notes of 10 marks each.
- An extra attempt is not marked, so never write a fifth answer.

NOTE • How the questions are numbered

Because the MCQs form Question 1, the descriptive questions are normally numbered **Q2 to Q8** (Section A: Q2–Q5; Section B: Q6–Q8). The accessible transcription of the 2024 paper numbers them 1 to 7; the substance is the same. Always read the printed instructions in the hall — they are the only authority on the day.

The 2015 exception

In 2015, the last year of the old scheme, British History was two separate papers, each with seven descriptive questions and its own objective part. Their questions are included in this record because they are the closest thing to the modern paper's Part I heads, and because examiners still reuse their themes (Palmerston, Methodism, Splendid Isolation, the Commonwealth).

1.5 The asymmetry that decides scores

On paper the two parts of the syllabus are equal. In the hall they are not, and the difference decides a candidate's score.

	Section A	Section B
Syllabus behind it	Part I: eleven heads, 1688–1939	Part II: three heads, 1939 onwards
Questions printed	4	3
You must answer	2 (a choice of 2 from 4)	2 (a choice of 2 from 3)
Freedom to skip	You may skip two	You may skip only one
What it means	A wide field with real choice	A narrow field with almost no choice

KEY IDEA · The first structural fact

Section B is close to compulsory. With three questions printed and two to be answered, you can avoid only one. And in six of the eleven papers since 2016 one of the three was a short-notes question, which forces you to know two of its three items. So **T8, T9 and T10 must be prepared completely** — every sub-head, every short-note possibility. They carry half the descriptive marks and allow the least escape.

KEY IDEA · The second structural fact — the leaks

Section B does not only ask Part II material. Nine Section-B items since 2016 came from **Part I** heads — the Eastern Question (2017), Splendid Isolation (2018), the League of Nations (2020), and six short-note options (Treaty of Berlin, Fabianism, Kitchener, Utilitarianism, the French Revolution's impact, Methodism). And in **2026** a Part II subject — the decline of the Empire after 1945 — appeared in **Section A**. The full list is in Part 3.5. A candidate who prepares only "their" section's topics can find a Section-B choice suddenly narrowed to one.

1.6 The marks and the minutes

THE THREE HOURS

Thirty-five minutes per answer is the whole secret — the fourth answer is where marks are lost

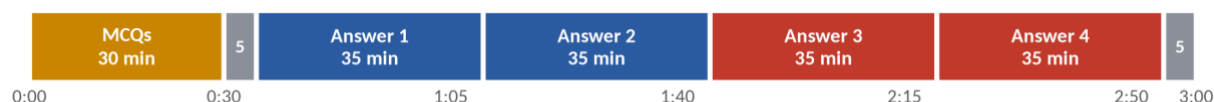


Figure 5 • The three hours. Thirty minutes for the objective part, then thirty-five minutes for each descriptive answer, with five minutes to choose and five to check.

The arithmetic is simple and unforgiving:

- **150 minutes for 80 marks** in Part II. Four answers of 20 marks each.
- Take **5 minutes** to read all seven questions and choose. Then **35 minutes per answer**. Keep **5 minutes** at the end to check headings and dates.
- Within each 35 minutes: **2 minutes** for the answer map, **30 minutes** writing, **3 minutes** for the sketch map or figure (drawn while you write, not after).
- At a comfortable handwriting speed this is about **1,000–1,300 words per answer** — roughly **7–9 sides** of an answer book with headings, a map and a table. The model answers in the QA documents are written to this length, so they are practical models, not impossible ones.
- For a **short-notes** question: **two notes of about 17 minutes each**, 450–600 words each.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT • Where marks are really lost

Not on the first answer, which is usually your best. Marks are lost on the **fourth**, which is written in twenty minutes because the first ran to fifty. A strong fourth answer is worth more than a brilliant first one. **Watch the clock at 1:05, 1:40, 2:15 and 2:50.**

1.7 The thirteen papers at a glance

The table below shows every paper since the single-paper scheme began, with each question's **family** and **topic**. The topics (T1–T10) are explained in Part Two. The full wording of every question is in Appendix A.

Year	Section A (answer two)	Section B (answer two)
2016	Q2 The French Revolution and Britain (T3) Q3 Parliamentary reform 1832–1928 (T5) Q4 Palmerston (T6) Q5 Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad (T6)	Q6 Thatcher and Thatcherism (T9) Q7 David Cameron (T10) Q8 short notes: Second World War (T8); Treaty of Berlin (T6); Fabianism (T4)
2017	Q2 Walpole and the Whig oligarchy (T2) Q3 The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution (T4) Q4 Chartism (T4) Q5 Gladstone's domestic policy (T5)	Q6 The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin (T6) Q7 The Commonwealth (T8) Q8 Brexit (T10)

Year	Section A (answer two)	Section B (answer two)
2018	Q2 The Glorious Revolution (T1) Q3 The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution (T4) Q4 Sir Robert Peel (T5) Q5 Parliamentary reform 1832–1928 (T5)	Q6 Splendid Isolation and its end (T6) Q7 The special relationship with the USA (T8) Q8 short notes: Sir Winston Churchill (T8); Britain's role in the EU (T9); Lady Diana (T10)
2019	Q2 The Glorious Revolution (T1) Q3 The Hanoverian succession (T2) Q4 The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution (T4) Q5 Parliamentary reform 1832–1928 (T5)	Q6 Attlee's Labour government 1945–51 (T8) Q7 Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez (T8) Q8 John Major (T9)
2020	Q2 Walpole and the Whig oligarchy (T2) Q3 The French Revolution and Britain (T3) Q4 Parliamentary reform 1832–1928 (T5) Q5 Sir Robert Peel (T5)	Q6 Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez (T8) Q7 Inter-war foreign policy and the League (T7) Q8 The Falklands War (T9)
2021	Q2 Church parties after 1688 (Non-Jurors, High Church, Latitudinarians) (T1) Q3 Union of England and Scotland, 1707 (T1) Q4 The First World War and its effects (T7) Q5 Edwardian era and the rise of Labour (T7)	Q6 The Falklands War (T9) Q7 Britain and Europe (EEC/EU) (T9) Q8 The War on Terror (T10)
2022	Q2 Gladstone's domestic policy (T5) Q3 Pitt the Elder (Chatham) (T2) Q4 Edwardian era and the rise of Labour (T7) Q5 The French Revolution and Britain (T3)	Q6 The Falklands War (T9) Q7 The Second World War and Churchill (T8) Q8 short notes: Lord Kitchener (T7); Suez Canal Crisis (T8); Utilitarianism (T4)
2023	Q2 The Glorious Revolution (T1) Q3 The French Revolution and Britain (T3) Q4 Splendid Isolation and its end (T6) Q5 The First World War and its effects (T7)	Q6 The Second World War and Churchill (T8) Q7 The War on Terror (T10) Q8 The 2008 financial crisis (T10)
2024	Q1 Sir Robert Peel (T5) Q2 The Irish Question and Home Rule (T5) Q3 Chartism (T4) Q4 The Methodist Movement (T4)	Q5 Thatcher and Thatcherism (T9) Q6 Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez (T8) Q7 short notes: Falkland War (T9); Reforms under David Cameron (T10); Creation of the Commonwealth (T8)
2025	Q2 William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession) (T1) Q3 Union with Ireland, 1801 (T3) Q4 Rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties (T5) Q5 Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism (T4)	Q6 Blair and New Labour (T10) Q7 The 2008 financial crisis (T10) Q8 short notes: Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society (T3); Methodist Movement (T4); Reforms under Cameron Government (T10)
2026	Q2 Slavery, abolition and empire (T2) Q3 The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution (T4) Q4 Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez (T8) Q5 The First World War and its effects (T7)	Q6 Britain and Europe (EEC/EU) (T9) Q7 Blair and New Labour (T10) Q8 short notes: Britain's role in the War on Terror (T10); Lady Diana Spencer (T10); John Major's foreign policy (T9)

And the two papers of 2015, under the former scheme:

Paper	Questions (attempt four of seven in each paper)
2015 Paper I	Q2 The Glorious Revolution (T1) Q3 William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession) (T1) Q4 Walpole and the Whig oligarchy (T2) Q5 American War of Independence (T2) Q6 Parliamentary reform 1832–1928 (T5) Q7 Palmerston (T6) Q8(a) short note: Industrial Revolution (T4) Q8(b) short note: Methodist Movement (T4) Q8(c) short note: Jacobite Revolt of Scotland (T2)
2015 Paper II	Q2 Palmerston (T6) Q3 The Methodist Movement (T4) Q4 Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad (T6) Q5 The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin (T6) Q6 The Commonwealth (T8) Q7 Splendid Isolation and its end (T6) Q8 Inter-war foreign policy and the League (T7)

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED • What the glance shows at once

Section A has **always** been four full questions. Section B has been three questions — and a **short-notes** question in **2016, 2018, 2022, 2024, 2025 and 2026**. Topics T8–T10 supplied **24 of the 27** full questions set in Section B since 2016.

Part Two — Ten Topics: Rebuilding the Syllabus as One Story

2.1 Why ten topics, and why in time order

The syllabus lists fourteen heads. Three of them — **III** (Union of England and Scotland), **IV** (Union of England and Ireland) and **V** (the Old Colonial System) — have **no dates** and are printed as separate themes after the Hanoverian era. Taken in the syllabus's own order, you would study the Hanoverians to 1790, then jump back to 1707 for the Scottish union, forward to 1801 for the Irish union, back to the seventeenth century for the colonial system, and forward again to 1789 for the French Revolution. For a reader who does not yet know the story, that order is a maze.

These notes follow **time** instead. Each of the three undated heads is placed where it actually happened:

Head	Placed in	Why there
III · Union with Scotland	T1 (1685–1714)	The Act of Union was passed in 1707 , in the middle of Queen Anne's reign — which is Head I. You cannot explain it without the Act of Settlement (1701), the Scottish Act of Security (1704) and the war with France, all Topic 1 material.
IV · Union with Ireland	T3 (1783–1815)	The Act of Union of 1801 was Pitt the Younger's answer to the Irish rebellion of 1798 , fought with French help during the war against Revolutionary France — which is Head VI.
V · The Old Colonial System	T2 (1714–1783)	The Old Colonial System (mercantilism, the Navigation Acts, the slave trade) was the empire of the eighteenth century . Its breakdown is the cause of the American War of Independence — which is Head II.

KEY IDEA · The rule behind the ten topics

A topic is a stretch of the story that an examiner can ask about as one question.

Topic boundaries fall where the story changes direction: 1714 (the Hanoverians arrive), 1783 (America lost, Pitt arrives), 1815 (Napoleon defeated), 1901 (Victoria dies), 1939 (war, and the syllabus's own Part I/II line), 1979 (Thatcher), 1997 (Blair). Two topics — **T4** (the Industrial Revolution) and **T6** (Victorian foreign policy) — run alongside others because they are *themes* that the examiner asks about as wholes.

2.2 From fourteen heads to ten topics

FROM FOURTEEN HEADS TO TEN TOPICS

Heads III, IV and V have no dates in the syllabus — each is placed where it happened in time

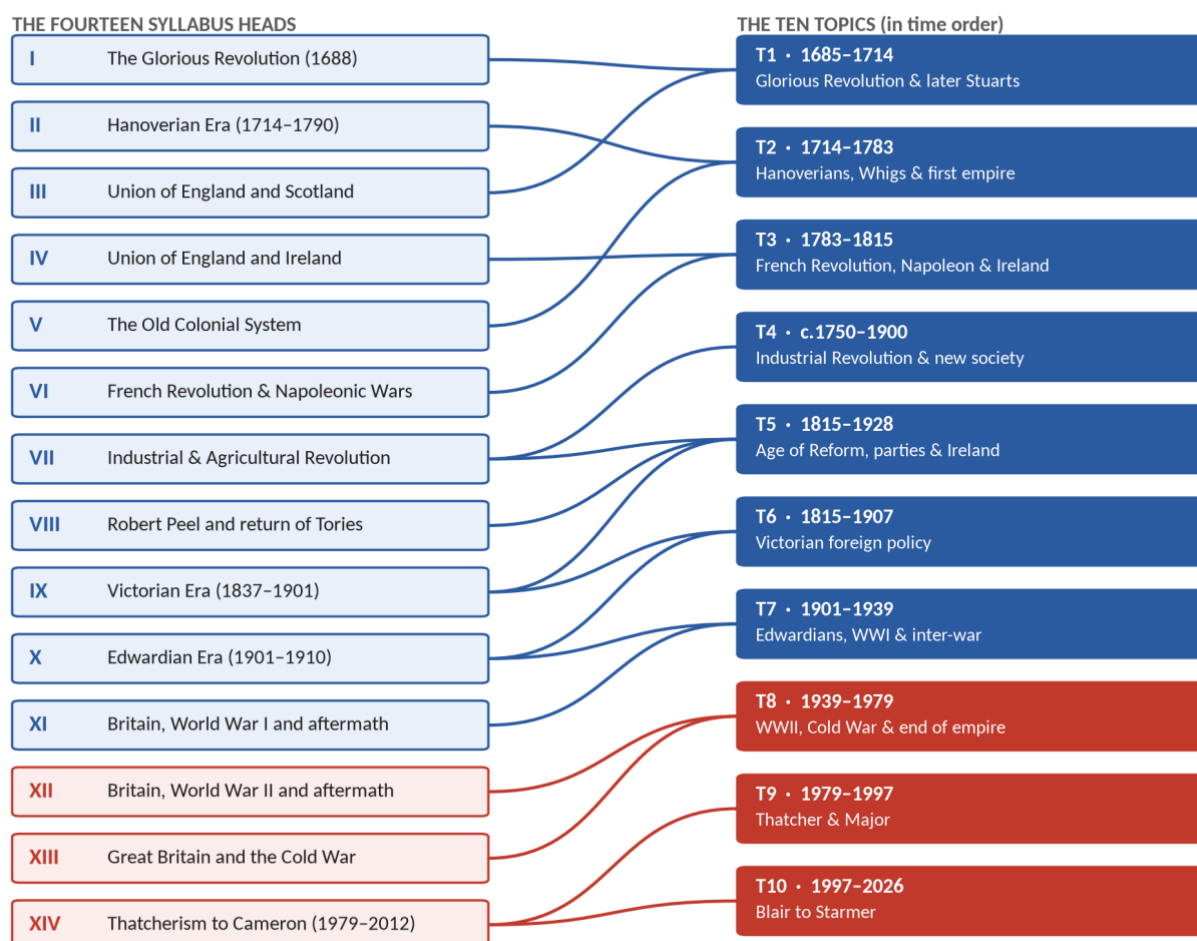


Figure 6 • How each of the fourteen syllabus heads feeds the ten topics. Blue = syllabus Part I; red = syllabus Part II.

Topic	Title	Syllabus heads	What the topic contains
T1	The Glorious Revolution and the Later Stuarts, 1685–1714	I, III	James II and his Declarations of Indulgence; the Revolution of 1688; the Bill of Rights; William III and Mary II; the Nine Years' War and Ryswick; the Church after 1688 (Non-Jurors, High Church, Latitudinarians); Queen Anne; the War of the Spanish Succession and Utrecht; the Act of Settlement; the Union of 1707
T2	Hanoverian Britain, the Whig Oligarchy and the First Empire, 1714–1783	II, V	The Hanoverian succession; the Jacobite risings of 1715 and 1745; Walpole and the Whig oligarchy; Pitt the Elder and the Seven Years' War; George III; the Old Colonial System ; the slave trade; the American War of Independence; the downfall of the Whigs

Topic	Title	Syllabus heads	What the topic contains
T3	Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland, 1783–1815	IV, VI	Pitt the Younger; the causes of the French Revolution; Burke and Paine; repression at home; the Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars (Nile, Trafalgar, Peninsula, Waterloo); the Congress of Vienna; the 1798 rising and the Union of 1801 ; the impact of the wars on Britain
T4	The Industrial and Agricultural Revolutions and the New Society, c.1750–1900	VII	Causes; enclosure and the Agricultural Revolution; coal, iron, steam, textiles, canals, railways; effects on society, politics and culture; Methodism; Utilitarianism; Liberalism; Socialism and Fabianism; colonisation; Chartism; the abolition of the slave trade and slavery (with T2)
T5	The Age of Reform: Parliament, Parties, Peel, Gladstone and Ireland, 1815–1928	VIII, IX (VII)	Post-war repression and Peterloo; Liverpool, Canning, Wellington; William IV's reforming decade; the Reform Acts 1832–1928; Peel, the Tamworth Manifesto and Corn Law repeal; the rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties; Gladstone's domestic reforms; Disraeli at home; free trade; the Irish Question and Home Rule to 1922
T6	Victorian Britain and the World: Palmerston to Splendid Isolation, 1815–1907	IX, X	Castlereagh and Canning; Palmerston; the Eastern Question; the Crimean War; Disraeli's foreign and imperial policy; the Congress of Berlin; Gladstone abroad; the Scramble for Africa; Splendid Isolation and its end (1902, 1904, 1907)
T7	Edwardian Britain, the Great War and the Road to 1939	X, XI	The Edwardian era; the Liberal reforms; the origins and rise of the Labour Party; the causes and course of the First World War; its effects on Britain; the peace settlement; the League of Nations; the Great Depression; appeasement and rearmament
T8	The Second World War, Attlee, the Cold War and the End of Empire, 1939–1979	XII, XIII	Causes and events of WWII; Churchill and the war conferences; the UN; effects of the war; Attlee's reforms; the Cold War, NATO and the special relationship; the Commonwealth; decolonisation (India, Palestine, Suez, Africa); Britain's road into the EEC; home policies to 1979
T9	Thatcher and Major: Thatcherism, the Falklands and Europe, 1979–1997	XIV	Thatcherism at home; society and culture in the 1980s; the Falklands War; foreign policy and the end of the Cold War; Britain and the European Community; Major, Maastricht and the formation of the EU; the 1992 and 1997 elections
T10	Blair to Burnham: New Labour, the War on Terror, Crisis and Brexit, 1997–2026	XIV + beyond	New Labour and its reforms; the War on Terror (Afghanistan, Iraq); Brown and the 2008 crisis; Cameron's coalition and reforms; Brexit; May, Johnson, Truss, Sunak, Starmer; Diana and the monarchy; society and culture

2.3 What each topic adds beyond the syllabus's words

The syllabus names the headline items. The examiner asks about more than the headlines. Each topic therefore includes material the syllabus does not name but the record shows is needed.

Topic	Added beyond the syllabus's words	Evidence from the record
T1	James II's Declarations of Indulgence; the Nine Years' War and Ryswick; the Church parties after 1688	2015 P1 Q2 and Q3; 2021 Q2
T2	Pitt the Elder (Chatham); the Seven Years' War; the slave trade and abolition	2022 Q3; 2026 Q2
T3	Pitt the Younger; Burke and Paine; the repression of 1793–1820	2016 Q2; 2020 Q3; 2023 Q3
T4	Utilitarianism and Fabianism (named only as "Socialism", "Liberalism")	2016 and 2022 short notes
T5	William IV's reign; Liverpool, Canning and Wellington; the Reform Acts to 1928	2015 P1 Q6; 2024 Q1; 2020 Q4
T6	Palmerston; the Eastern Question; Crimea; Berlin; Splendid Isolation	Ten questions, 2015–2023
T7	Kitchener; the Liberal decline; Kipling and wartime propaganda	2022 short note; 2026 Q5; 2023 Q5
T8	Palestine; the special relationship; Churchill as writer	2020 Q6; 2018 Q7; 2022 Q7
T9	The miners' strike; the 1992 election; Maastricht opt-outs	2019 Q8; 2026 Q6
T10	Brexit; post-2012 governments to 2026; Diana	2017 Q8; 2018 and 2026 short notes

2.4 Why the syllabus stops in 2012 — and these notes run to 2026

The syllabus was written for the 2016 examination, so its last head ends with "Reforms under Cameron" (2010–2012). But the examiner has already gone beyond it:

- **2017 Q8** asked about the **advantages and disadvantages of Brexit** — an event of 2016.
- **2024** and **2025** set short notes on **Cameron's reforms** — his whole premiership, to 2016.
- **2026 Q7** framed the whole period **1997–2012** as a question about renewal or contradiction — which cannot be answered well without knowing how the story ended.

And the Europe question (asked **2018, 2021, 2026**) cannot be answered well today without its final chapter — Britain's exit in 2020 — in view.

VERDICT • So these notes run to September 2026

Topic 10 covers **Blair to Burnham**: Brexit, the governments of May, Johnson, Truss and Sunak, the death of Elizabeth II, the accession of Charles III, and Starmer's government from July 2024. The material after 2012 is presented as history, with the same structure as the rest — not as an afterthought.

2.5 The two documents each topic gets

Every topic from T1 to T10 gets exactly two Word documents, in its own folder.

The Knowledge Base (TnKB)

- **The story so far** — a short bridge from the previous topic (from T2 onwards).
- **The story itself** — the topic told as a narrative in simple language, before any analysis.
- **The cast** — the people, with dates and one line each.
- **The time-line** — as a figure and as a table.
- **The chapters** — the topic broken into causes, course, results and significance, under many layers of headings, with maps, family trees, flow charts and comparison tables.
- **The historians** — who said what, and how to quote them.
- **The examiner boxes** — where each part has been asked.
- **The one-liner MCQs** — fifty to a hundred facts per topic, in question-and-answer form.
- **The revision sheet** — the whole topic on a few pages, written so that it makes complete sense on its own (it will be combined into the exam-night document).

The Question Answers (TnQA)

- **Every past question** on the topic, 2015–2026, answered in full: the question; *decoding the question*; the **answer map** (mind map) built on the question's own words; the model answer under numbered headings with a sketch map, figure or table; and *why this answer scores*.
- **Every short-note option** on the topic, answered.
- **The topic's MCQs** from 2024–2026, solved with a one-line explanation.
- **At most five predicted questions**, each with a short outline.

NOTE · Near-identical questions

Where the examiner has set the same question twice (for example **2020 Q3** and **2022 Q5**, word for word), the answer is written once in full, and the second listing shows how to adapt it. Where two questions look similar but ask for different things, each gets its own answer.

Part Three — The Record: What Has Been Asked, 2015–2026

3.1 How the record was built

The record covers **thirteen papers**: the two papers of 2015 (former scheme) and the eleven single papers of 2016 to 2026.

- **Descriptive:** 84 full questions and 7 short-notes questions containing **21 options**, all transcribed in full in Appendix A. Each item was tagged four ways: its **topic** (T1–T10), its **family** (the thing it is really about, such as "Walpole and the Whig oligarchy"), its **syllabus head** (I–XIV) and its **shape** (causes-and-results, quotation to evaluate, "how far", and so on).
- **Objective:** 60 MCQs — the complete objective papers of **2024, 2025 and 2026**. The objective sheets of 2015–2023 could not be recovered from accessible scans and **none has been invented**. The 60 items are listed with their keyed answers in Appendix B.
- **Weighting:** in the charts, a full question counts **1** and a short-note option counts **½** (because you write two notes for one question's marks).

NOTE · What the record can and cannot tell you

It tells you **what the examiner likes to ask** and **how he likes to ask it**. It cannot tell you what will be asked next — 2023 and 2026 both set questions nobody had seen before (Kipling's quotation; abolition and imperialism). Use the record to decide **what to prepare first and deepest**, never what to leave out.

3.2 The heat map

THIRTEEN PAPERS, TEN TOPICS

Every descriptive item 2015–2026. Number = full questions; "sn" = short-note options. Red line = syllabus Part I / Part II

	2015	2015														
	P1	P2	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026			
T1 Glorious Revolution & later Stuarts	2				1	1		2		1		1		8 Q + 0 sn		
T2 Hanoverians, Whigs & first empire	2+1sn			1		1	1		1				1	7 Q + 1 sn		
T3 French Revolution, Napoleon & Ireland			1				1		1	1		1+1sn		5 Q + 1 sn		
T4 Industrial Revolution & new society	2sn	1	1sn	2	1	1			1sn		2	1+1sn	1	9 Q + 5 sn		
T5 Age of Reform, parties & Ireland	1		1	1	2	1	2		1		2	1		12 Q + 0 sn		
T6 Victorian foreign policy	1	4	2+1sn	1	1					1				10 Q + 1 sn		
T7 Edwardians, WWI & inter-war		1					1	2	1+1sn	1			1	7 Q + 1 sn		
T8 WWII, Cold War & end of empire		1	1sn	1	1+1sn	2	1		1+1sn	1	1+1sn		1	10 Q + 4 sn		
T9 Thatcher & Major			1		1sn	1	1	2	1		1+1sn		1+1sn	8 Q + 3 sn		
T10 Blair to Starmer			1	1	1sn			1		2	1sn	2+1sn	1+2sn	8 Q + 5 sn		

Figure 7 • Every descriptive item of 2015–2026 by topic and paper. Numbers are full questions; "sn" marks short-note options. Darker = more.

How to read it

- **Across a row** you see how regularly a topic appears. T4 (Industrial Revolution and society), T5 (Age of Reform) and T8 (WWII to decolonisation) appear in almost every paper.
- **Down a column** you see the shape of one paper. Above the red line is Section A territory; below it is Section B.
- **The white gaps** show where a topic rested — and topics that rest usually return. T6 (Victorian foreign policy) filled the 2015–2018 papers, disappeared after 2018 except for 2023, and is therefore **due**.

3.3 How much each topic weighs

WHERE THE MARKS HAVE COME FROM

T4, T5, T8 and T10 lead the descriptive record; T8 and T10 also lead the objective paper

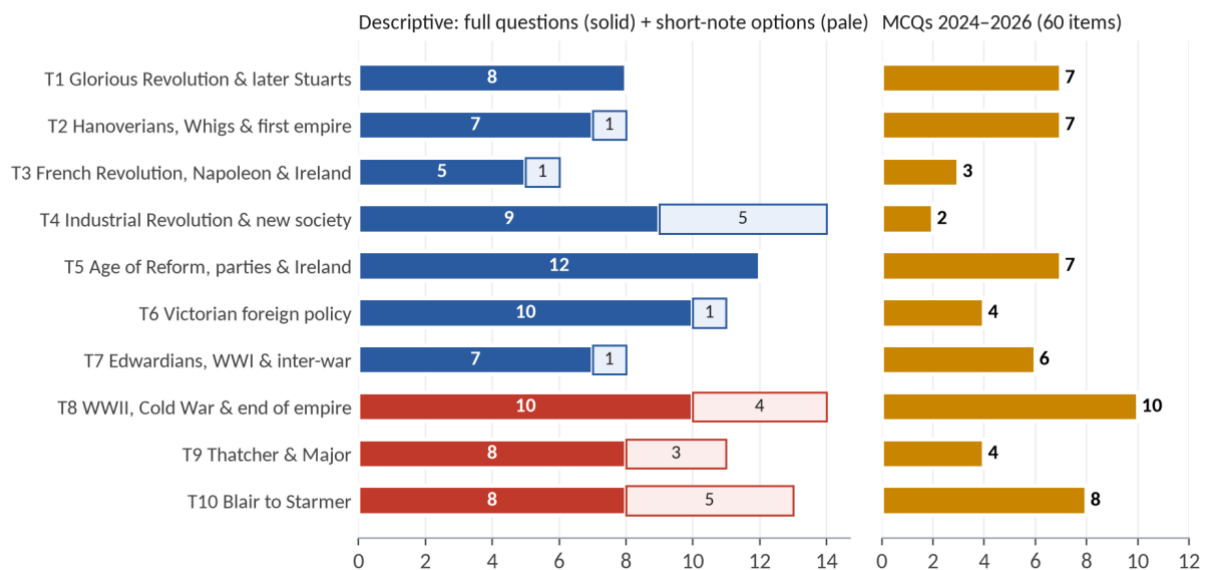


Figure 8 • Descriptive items per topic (left) and objective items 2024–2026 per topic (right).

Topic	Full Qs	Short notes	Weight*	Share	MCQs	Rank
T1 Glorious Revolution & later Stuarts	8	0	8	8%	7	7
T2 Hanoverians, Whigs & first empire	7	1	7.5	8%	7	8
T3 French Revolution, Napoleon & Ireland	5	1	5.5	6%	3	10
T4 Industrial Revolution & new society	9	5	11.5	12%	2	3
T5 Age of Reform, parties & Ireland	12	0	12	13%	7	1
T6 Victorian foreign policy	10	1	10.5	11%	4	4
T7 Edwardians, WWI & inter-war	7	1	7.5	8%	6	9
T8 WWII, Cold War & end of empire	10	4	12	13%	10	2
T9 Thatcher & Major	8	3	9.5	10%	4	6
T10 Blair to Burnham	8	5	10.5	11%	8	5
Total	84	21	94.5	100%	60	

*Weight = full questions + $\frac{1}{2} \times$ short-note options. Share = the topic's weight as a percentage of all descriptive weight.

KEY IDEA · What the weights mean for you

No topic is small. The lightest (T3) still carries **6%** of the descriptive record; the heaviest (T5 and T8) carry **13%** each. The spread is narrow because the paper forces choice across the whole period: four Section-A questions must come from seven topics, three Section-B questions from three. So the right strategy is **complete coverage with graded depth** — not a gamble on a few topics.

3.4 The repeat engine

THE REPEAT ENGINE

Nineteen question families asked three times or more. Filled dot = full question · ring = short note · blue = Part I · red = Part II

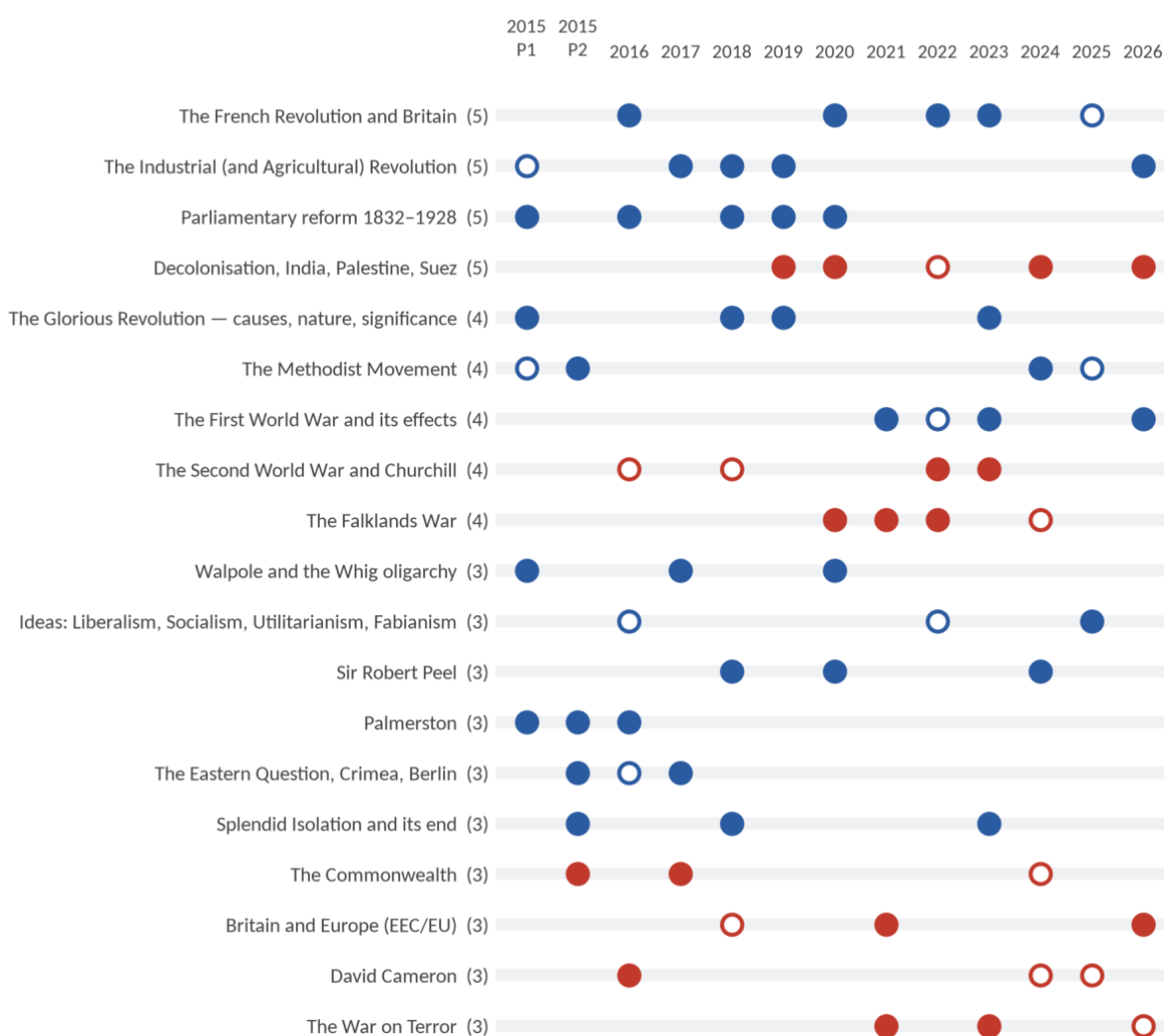


Figure 9 · The nineteen question families asked three times or more. Each dot is one appearance.

The central fact of this paper is that **it repeats**. Nineteen families have appeared three or more times, and they account for **70 of the 105** descriptive items (two-thirds). Twelve more families have appeared twice.

The families asked three times or more

Family	Times	Topic	When (Q = full question, sn = short note)
The French Revolution and Britain	5	T3	2016, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2025 sn
The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	5	T4	2015 P1 sn, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2026
Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	5	T5	2015 P1, 2016, 2018, 2019, 2020
Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	5	T8	2019, 2020, 2022 sn, 2024, 2026
The Glorious Revolution — causes, nature, significance	4	T1	2015 P1, 2018, 2019, 2023
The Methodist Movement	4	T4	2015 P1 sn, 2015 P2, 2024, 2025 sn
The First World War and its effects	4	T7	2021, 2022 sn, 2023, 2026
The Second World War and Churchill	4	T8	2016 sn, 2018 sn, 2022, 2023
The Falklands War	4	T9	2020, 2021, 2022, 2024 sn
Walpole and the Whig oligarchy	3	T2	2015 P1, 2017, 2020
Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism	3	T4	2016 sn, 2022 sn, 2025
Sir Robert Peel	3	T5	2018, 2020, 2024
Palmerston	3	T6	2015 P1, 2015 P2, 2016
The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin	3	T6	2015 P2, 2016 sn, 2017
Splendid Isolation and its end	3	T6	2015 P2, 2018, 2023
The Commonwealth	3	T8	2015 P2, 2017, 2024 sn
Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)	3	T9	2018 sn, 2021, 2026
David Cameron	3	T10	2016, 2024 sn, 2025 sn
The War on Terror	3	T10	2021, 2023, 2026 sn

The families asked twice

Family	Times	Topic	When (Q = full question, sn = short note)
William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession)	2	T1	2015 P1, 2025
Chartism	2	T4	2017, 2024
Gladstone's domestic policy	2	T5	2017, 2022
Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad	2	T6	2015 P2, 2016
Inter-war foreign policy and the League	2	T7	2015 P2, 2020
Edwardian era and the rise of Labour	2	T7	2021, 2022
Thatcher and Thatcherism	2	T9	2016, 2024
John Major	2	T9	2019, 2026 sn

Family	Times	Topic	When (Q = full question, sn = short note)
Diana, Princess of Wales	2	T10	2018 sn, 2026 sn
The 2008 financial crisis	2	T10	2023, 2025
Blair and New Labour	2	T10	2025, 2026

The families asked once

Family	Times	Topic	When (Q = full question, sn = short note)
Church parties after 1688 (Non-Jurors, High Church, Latitudinarians)	1	T1	2021
Union of England and Scotland, 1707	1	T1	2021
American War of Independence	1	T2	2015 P1
The Jacobite risings	1	T2	2015 P1 sn
The Hanoverian succession	1	T2	2019
Pitt the Elder (Chatham)	1	T2	2022
Slavery, abolition and empire	1	T2	2026
Union with Ireland, 1801	1	T3	2025
The Irish Question and Home Rule	1	T5	2024
Rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties	1	T5	2025
The special relationship with the USA	1	T8	2018
Attlee's Labour government 1945–51	1	T8	2019
Brexit	1	T10	2017

Exact and near repeats

Some questions have come back **in the same or almost the same words**. These are the clearest evidence of how the examiner works.

Pair or group	What stayed the same	What changed
2020 Q3 = 2022 Q5	<i>"Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought."</i> — identical	Nothing. Two years apart.
2017 Q2 ≈ 2020 Q2	Merits and demerits of Whig rule / Whig oligarchy; causes of its downfall	"Analyze comprehensively" became "critically examine"
2017 Q5 ≈ 2022 Q2	"Gladstone's domestic policy was the climax of liberalism"	"During the 19th century" added
2015 P2 Q6 ≈ 2017 Q7	How the Commonwealth developed; how it differs from the Empire	Also a short note, 2024

Pair or group	What stayed the same	What changed
2020 Q8 ≈ 2022 Q6	Causes (genesis) of the Falklands War; effect on relations with Latin America	"Causes" became "genesis". Also 2021 and a 2024 short note
2016 Q3 ≈ 2019 Q5	The Reform Act of 1832	2019 asks about what it made possible afterwards
2018 Q5 ≈ 2020 Q4	The democratisation of Parliament	2020 fixes the dates: 1832–1928
2017 Q3 ≈ 2019 Q4	Effects of the Industrial Revolution on social, economic, political and cultural life	2019 adds its causes; 2026 turns it into "disruption or progress?"
2018 Q2 ≈ 2019 Q2 ≈ 2023 Q2	The Glorious Revolution: how, why, and what followed	Each asks from a different angle: causes (2018), "so glorious" (2019), fallout at home and abroad (2023)
2015 P1 Q7 ≈ 2015 P2 Q2 ≈ 2016 Q4	A quotation about Palmerston to evaluate	Three different quotations
2015 P2 Q7 ≈ 2018 Q6 ≈ 2023 Q4	Splendid Isolation	Why adopted (2015, 2023); how ended (2018)
2018 Q4 ≈ 2020 Q5 ≈ 2024 Q1	Sir Robert Peel	Policies (2018); a quotation (2020); compared with predecessors (2024)
2015 P2 Q3 ≈ 2024 Q4 (+ 2 short notes)	The emergence and features of Methodism	Effects (2015); reasons for success (2024)
2017 Q4 ≈ 2024 Q3	Chartism	Why it failed (2017); why millions supported it (2024)
2021 Q5 ≈ 2022 Q4	The rise of the Labour Party	Edwardian setting (2021); achievements (2022)
2021 Q8 ≈ 2023 Q7 ≈ 2026 sn	Britain and the War on Terror	Blair's policy (2021); a Bush quotation (2023)
2023 Q8 ≈ 2025 Q7	The 2008 financial crisis and Britain	2025 adds a Labour–Conservative comparison
2024 sn = 2025 sn	"Reforms under (the) Cameron (Government)"	Consecutive years
2018 sn = 2026 sn	Lady Diana (Spencer)	Eight years apart

KEY IDEA · How the repeat engine works

The examiner returns to a small number of favourite subjects and changes the angle. A subject asked for its *causes* comes back asking for its *results*; one asked through a *quotation* comes back as *compare with predecessors*. So preparing a family means preparing **all its angles** — causes, course, results, significance, critics, and comparison — not memorising one past answer. Every QA document in this set is organised around this rule.

3.5 The leaks between the sections

Section A is meant to carry syllabus Part I and Section B syllabus Part II. In practice the line leaks — mostly one way.

Paper	Item	Syllabus head	Topic
2016 §B · Q8(b)	Short note: Treaty of Berlin	IX · Part I head in Section B	T6
2016 §B · Q8(c)	Short note: Fabianism	VII · Part I head in Section B	T4
2017 §B · Q6	Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.	IX · Part I head in Section B	T6
2018 §B · Q6	How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What were its positive and negative aspects?	X · Part I head in Section B	T6
2020 §B · Q7	What do you know about the League of Nations? Explain the work of the League. What were the causes of its failure?	XI · Part I head in Section B	T7
2022 §B · Q8(a)	Short note: Lord Kitchener	XI · Part I head in Section B	T7
2022 §B · Q8(c)	Short note: Utilitarianism	VII · Part I head in Section B	T4
2025 §B · Q8(a)	Short note: Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society	VI · Part I head in Section B	T3
2025 §B · Q8(b)	Short note: Methodist Movement	VII · Part I head in Section B	T4
2026 §A · Q4	How far was the decline of the British Empire after 1945 the result of global pressures rather than internal political decisions? Support your analysis with at least three major real end-of-decolonisation cases.	XIII · Part II head in Section A	T8

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · What the leaks mean

Nine Part I items have appeared in Section B since 2016 (three full questions and six short-note options), and in **2026** one Part II question (the end of empire after 1945) appeared in Section A. So your Section B choice can include a nineteenth-century question, and your Section A choice can include a post-1945 one. **Prepare every topic to at least short-note level.**

3.6 The blind spots — syllabus lines never asked

These are items the syllabus names that have **never** been set as a descriptive question (or appear only inside a larger question) in 2015–2026. A blind spot is not a safe place to skip: several are exactly where the next surprise will come from.

Head	Never asked descriptively	Comment
I	William III and Mary II's reign as a subject in itself	Asked only through the wars (2015) and the Church (2021).
II	The Jacobite rebellions as a full question	Only a 2015 short note. The '45 is a natural 2027 short note.
V	The Old Colonial System	Never — though 2026 Q2 (abolition and empire) comes closest. A full question on mercantilism and the Navigation Acts is overdue.
VI	Britain and the Napoleonic Wars (the fighting itself)	The Revolution's <i>influence</i> has been asked five times; the <i>war</i> — Trafalgar, the Peninsula, Waterloo, Vienna — never.
VII	Colonization; Socialism alone; Liberalism alone	Only in the 2025 comparison and short notes.
VIII	The Irish problem under Peel (Maynooth, the Famine)	Only inside 2018 Q4.
IX	Great Britain and Free Trade ; Victorian internal reforms in general	Free trade only as a 2025 MCQ.
X	Edwardian foreign policy (Entente Cordiale, Anglo-Russian Convention)	Only as the end of Splendid Isolation.
XI	The peace settlement; the Great Depression; appeasement and rearmament	Only 2015 P2 Q8 (foreign policy 1919–39). Appeasement is the largest blind spot in Part I.
XII	The war conferences; the creation of the UN	Never.
XIII	NATO ; home policies and the EEC before 1973	Never directly.
XIV	Society and culture (beyond Diana); Brown's premiership	Society and culture is named in the syllabus and almost untouched.

3.7 Beyond the syllabus — what the examiner asked that the syllabus never names

The opposite of a blind spot: questions whose subjects are **not** in the syllabus's words.

- **James II's Declarations of Indulgence** (2015) and the **Non-Jurors, High Churchmen and Latitudinarians** (2021).
- **The War of the League of Augsburg** and the **Treaty of Ryswick** (2015).
- **Pitt the Elder / Chatham** (2022) and **William IV** (2015).
- **Palmerston** (three times), **the Eastern Question**, **the Crimean War**, **the Treaty of Berlin** and **Splendid Isolation** (three times) — under the thin heading "Foreign Policy".
- **Utilitarianism** and **Fabianism** (short notes).
- **Lord Kitchener**, **Rudyard Kipling** and **Palestine**.
- **Brexit** (2017) and **Lady Diana** (2018, 2026).
- **Abolition and imperialism** (2026).

VERDICT · The syllabus is a floor, not a ceiling

The examiner treats each head as a **period**, not a list. Anything important that happened in the period can be asked. The Knowledge Bases therefore cover each period fully, not only the named sub-heads.

3.8 The objective paper, 2024–2026

Sixty MCQs survive, twenty from each of the last three years. Their topic spread is in the right-hand chart of Part 3.3. What matters more is **what kind of knowledge they test**.

Topic	MCQs	What was asked (year · item → answer)
T1 Glorious Revolution & later Stuarts	7	2024-8: The Act of Union between England and Scotland took effect in: → B. 1707 2024-18: The League of Augsburg was signed in: → D. None of these — the League was formed in 1686 2025-1: What key document affirmed parliamentary supremacy after the Glorious Revolution? → B. Bill of Rights 2025-2: Which dynasty came to power after the Glorious Revolution? → D. None of these — William III of Orange and Mary II (a Stuart) reigned jointly; the Hanoverians began in 1714 2025-5: The Act of Union between England and Scotland was passed in: → B. 1707 2026-1: Which monarch ruled jointly with William III after 1689? → D. None of these — Mary II 2026-2: The Act of Settlement 1701 secured the crown for which house? → A. Hanover
T2 Hanoverians, Whigs & first empire	7	2024-1: Who is the longest-serving British Prime Minister? → A. Robert Walpole 2024-13: Who was the British monarch during the American Revolutionary War? → C. George III 2025-3: What was the primary cause of the Jacobite rebellions? → D. None of these — the central issue was the Stuart dynastic claim, intertwined with religion 2025-4: Which issue most directly led to the American War of Independence? → B. Taxation 2026-3: The Seven Years' War established British dominance over: → C. French North America 2026-4: Who was Prime Minister during the American Declaration of Independence? → B. Lord North 2026-14: The American War of Independence ended with the: → A. Treaty of Paris 1783
T3 French Revolution, Napoleon & Ireland	3	2024-15: The Battle of Waterloo was fought on: → A. 18 June 1815 2026-5: The Act of Union 1801 created the United Kingdom of: → C. Great Britain and Ireland 2026-15: The French Revolution led to Britain: → D. None of these — revolutionary France declared war on Great Britain on 1 February 1793
T4 Industrial Revolution & new society	2	2025-6: Which religious movement emphasised personal piety and social reform? → C. Methodism 2025-7: What was the main political demand of the Chartists? → B. Universal male suffrage

Topic	MCQs	What was asked (year · item → answer)
T5 Age of Reform, parties & Ireland	7	2024-19: Who was the longest-reigning Hanoverian monarch? → D. None of these — Queen Victoria 2025-8: Which Prime Minister repealed the Corn Laws? → C. Robert Peel 2025-10: Which economic policy dominated Victorian Britain? → B. Free trade 2026-6: The Peterloo Massacre occurred in which city? → D. None of these — Manchester 2026-7: The Irish Famine was chiefly caused by the failure of which crop? → C. Potato 2026-8: Women over the age of 30 first gained the parliamentary vote in: → D. None of these — 1918 2026-16: The Reform Act 1832 extended political representation mainly to: → C. Middle-class men
T6 Victorian foreign policy	4	2024-2: The British colony of Singapore was established as a trading post along which important maritime route? → B. Strait of Malacca 2024-3: The “Scramble for Africa” refers to the period of intense European colonial expansion in Africa during which centuries? → C. 19th and 20th centuries 2024-17: The early Victorian Anglo-Russian rivalry known as the “Great Game” was: → D. None of these — it was a wider geopolitical rivalry in Central Asia 2026-17: The Crimean War was fought by Britain against: → A. Russia
T7 Edwardians, WWI & inter-war	6	2024-5: The Treaty of Versailles was signed on: → C. 28 June 1919 2024-6: How many British Prime Ministers served during World War I? → A. Two — H. H. Asquith and David Lloyd George 2024-20: King Edward VIII announced his abdication from the British throne on: → C. 11 December 1936 2025-9: Which monarch gave the Edwardian era its name? → C. Edward VII 2025-12: What was Britain's policy toward Nazi Germany in the late 1930s called? → C. Appeasement 2026-18: The policy of appeasement is most closely associated with: → B. Neville Chamberlain
T8 WWII, Cold War & end of empire	10	2024-7: Which adjective is commonly associated with London in the 1960s? → C. Swinging 2024-11: The Bank of England was nationalised in: → B. 1946 2024-12: Queen Elizabeth II was crowned on: → A. 2 June 1953 2024-14: Apartheid was implemented in which African country? → B. South Africa 2025-11: Which British Prime Minister made the “Iron Curtain” speech famous after Winston Churchill used the term? → D. None of these — Winston Churchill himself delivered the famous 1946 Fulton speech 2025-13: What is the process by which former colonies gained independence called? → C. Decolonization 2025-16: What was the codename for the Dunkirk evacuation? → B. Operation Dynamo 2025-17: What was the German bombing campaign against Britain during World War II called? → A. The Blitz 2026-9: Who was Prime Minister during the Winter of Discontent? → B. James Callaghan 2026-19: The Suez Crisis resulted in: → A. British withdrawal
T9 Thatcher & Major	4	2024-9: Who succeeded Margaret Thatcher as Prime Minister? → D. None of these — John Major 2025-14: Which Prime Minister is most closely associated with large-scale privatisation of British industries? → A. Margaret Thatcher 2025-19: Which group led the major 1984–85 industrial action? → A. Miners 2026-10: Britain's first female Prime Minister belonged to which party? → C. Conservative

Topic	MCQs	What was asked (year · item → answer)
T10 Blair to Burnham	8	2024-10: Which Prime Minister sent British troops to Iraq in 2003? → B. Tony Blair 2025-15: Which party governed under Tony Blair? → B. Labour Party 2025-18: The global economic downturn beginning in 2008 is generally called the: → B. Financial Crisis 2025-20: David Cameron formed which type of government in 2010? → B. Coalition government 2026-11: The Good Friday Agreement addressed conflict in: → B. Northern Ireland 2026-12: The London 7/7 bombings occurred in: → D. None of these — 2005 2026-13: The 2010 coalition government joined the Conservatives with: → C. Liberal Democrats 2026-20: The 2010–15 coalition government was led by: → A. David Cameron
General knowledge	2	2024-4: What is the highest rank in the British nobility? → B. Duke 2024-16: Which of the following was not part of the British Empire? → B. Spain

What the sixty MCQs teach

- About one in six asks for an exact date or year** — the Treaty of Versailles (28 June 1919), Elizabeth II's coronation (2 June 1953), Waterloo (18 June 1815), Edward VIII's abdication (11 December 1936), the Bank of England's nationalisation (1946), the 7/7 bombings (2005). Days and months matter, not only years.
- About one in four asks for a person** — especially Prime Ministers and monarchs.
- Twelve of the sixty (20%) are keyed "None of these"**, because the options printed did not contain the right answer (for example: "longest-reigning Hanoverian?" with only Edwards offered — answer **Victoria**; "who made the Iron Curtain speech famous after Churchill used the term?" — it was Churchill himself). You must know the fact well enough to reject all three printed options with confidence.
- The objective paper spreads across all ten topics**, with T8 (10 items), T10 (8), T1, T2 and T5 (7 each) leading. Topics with few descriptive MCQs, like T3 and T4, still need their core facts.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · The "None of these" discipline

If you are sure the right answer is missing, choose D. Do not pick the "nearest" option. In 2024–2026 D was correct in **4, 3 and 5** items respectively.

3.9 How the questions are shaped

Every descriptive question falls into one of eight shapes. Knowing the shape tells you the structure of the answer before you know the history.

THE PAPER IS ASKING FOR JUDGEMENT

"How far" questions more than quadrupled in share after 2020; plain causes-and-results questions fell away

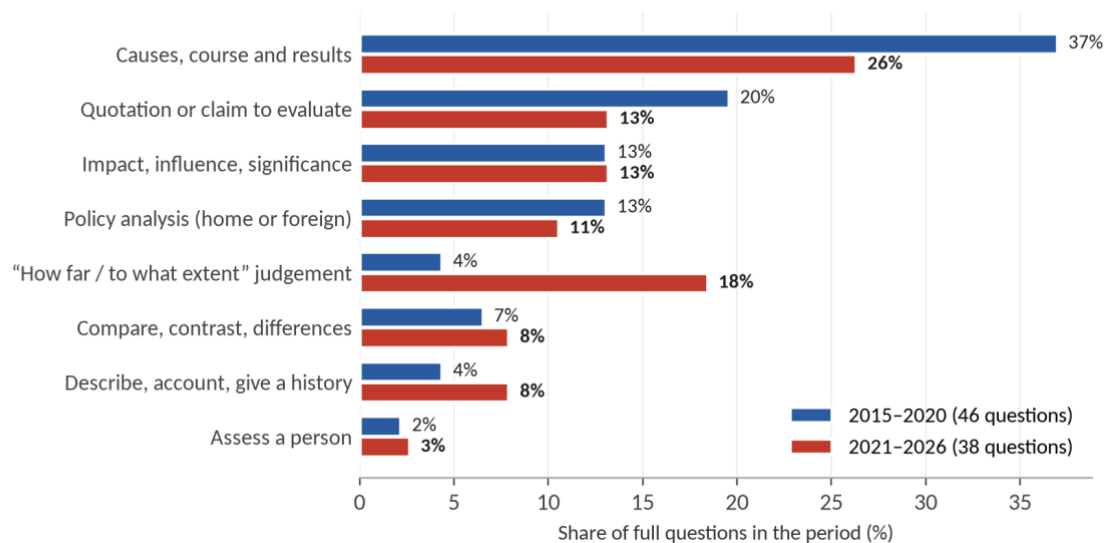


Figure 10 • The eight shapes of question, 2015–2020 against 2021–2026.

Shape	Typical wording	What the answer must do
Causes, course and results	"What led to..."; "What were the causes and consequences..."; "How did X occur? What was its fallout?"	Causes (long-term, short-term, trigger) → what happened → results (short- and long-term). Rank the causes.
Quotation or claim to evaluate	"'Peel was the most liberal of conservatives...' Examine."	Explain what the quotation means → the case for it → the case against → your verdict on how far it is true.
Impact, influence, significance	"Estimate the influence..."; "What was the significance of..."	Name the areas of impact (political, social, economic, religious, international) → evidence in each → which impact mattered most and lasted longest.
Policy analysis	"Discuss the foreign policy of..."; "Shed light on the interior and exterior policy..."	Aims → methods → achievements → failures → assessment.
"How far / to what extent" judgement	"How far was the decline of the Empire the result of global pressures rather than internal decisions?"	Weigh the named factor against the alternatives; give a clear percentage-style verdict ("largely", "only partly").
Compare / contrast / differences	"Compare and contrast Socialism and Liberalism..."; "How does it differ from..."	Organise by point of comparison , not by one thing then the other; finish with the deepest difference.
Describe / account / give a history	"Give a history of parliamentary reforms 1832–1928"	Chronological, but every stage must say what changed and why it mattered .
Assess a person	"Discuss Churchill as a statesman, warrior and man of letters"	One heading per role the question names; strengths and weaknesses in each; overall verdict.

KEY IDEA · The shift you must prepare for

From 2015–2020 to 2021–2026 the share of **"how far / to what extent"** questions rose from **4% to 18%**, while plain causes-and-results questions fell from **37% to 26%**. The newest papers want **argument and judgement**: a clear thesis at the start, a counter-view, and a verdict. Narrative alone now scores in the middle band at best.

3.10 The command words, decoded

The first word of a question tells you what to do. These are all the command words used in 2015–2026, with how often each introduced a full question (a question can use more than one).

Command	Times	What it demands
What were / What was / What led to / What do you know / In what way	25	Explanation with evidence. Deceptively simple: still needs an argument about <i>which</i> causes or features mattered most.
How did / How far / How has	20	"How did" = the process, step by step. " How far " = a judgement of extent — you must say <i>how far</i> , in words like "largely" or "only partly".
Discuss	17	Examine from more than one side and reach a conclusion. Never a one-sided account.
Explain	10	Make clear <i>why</i> or <i>how</i> ; causes and connections, not description.
Critically analyse / examine / evaluate	7	Break into parts, test each against evidence, show the weaknesses as well as strengths, and judge.
Analyse	6	Break the subject into its parts and show how they relate.
Why	5	Causes only — ranked, with the most important argued.
Examine	3	Investigate closely, weighing evidence.
Describe	3	Give an account — but add significance or you will stay in the middle band.
Shed light on / Elucidate	4	Explain clearly, often of a quotation — meaning first, then evidence.
Estimate / Assess	4	Weigh the importance and give a measured verdict.
Comment / Substantiate	3	React to a statement with evidence; "substantiate" means <i>prove it true</i> with evidence.
Do you agree / Argue / Was it...	5	Take a side, clearly, and defend it — while showing you understand the other side.
Give an account / a history / Provide an account / Account for	4	Chronological narrative that shows change over time.
Define	2	A precise one- or two-sentence definition <i>first</i> , before anything else.
Compare and contrast	1	Similarities and differences, point by point.
Enumerate / Highlight	2	List clearly, with a line or two on each.
Produce an analytical essay / Present a balanced critique	2	A full argued essay; balance is compulsory.

3.11 What changed between 2015 and 2026

- 1. From narrative to judgement.** "How far" questions more than quadrupled in share (Part 3.9). The 2025 and 2026 papers ask candidates to *argue for or against*, to *critically evaluate the extent*, to *assess whether* — every question demands a verdict.
- 2. From high politics to ideas and society.** Recent Section-A questions ask about Socialism against Liberalism (2025), party politics and the electorate (2025), abolition and imperialism (2026), and the Industrial Revolution as disruption (2026).
- 3. Victorian foreign policy has gone quiet.** Palmerston, Crimea and the Eastern Question filled the 2015–2017 papers and have not been set since 2017 (Splendid Isolation returned in 2023). A quiet family is a due family.
- 4. Section B has moved towards the present.** Topic 10 (1997 onwards) supplied **16%** of Section B's weighted items in 2016–2020 (2.5 of 16) but **40%** since 2021 (8 of 20).
- 5. Questions now name their requirements.** "Use regional examples" (2026 Q3); "at least three major real end-of-decolonisation cases" (2026 Q4); "with particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro" (2026 Q6). An answer that ignores a named requirement cannot reach the top band.
- 6. Short notes are now routine in Section B** — every year from 2024 to 2026.
- 7. The repeats continue:** Cameron's reforms in consecutive years (2024, 2025); Diana in 2018 and 2026; the French Revolution's influence in the same words in 2020 and 2022.

3.12 Where the next paper could come from

WHERE TO SPEND YOUR HOURS

Bubble size = MCQs 2024–26. Blue = syllabus Part I, red = Part II

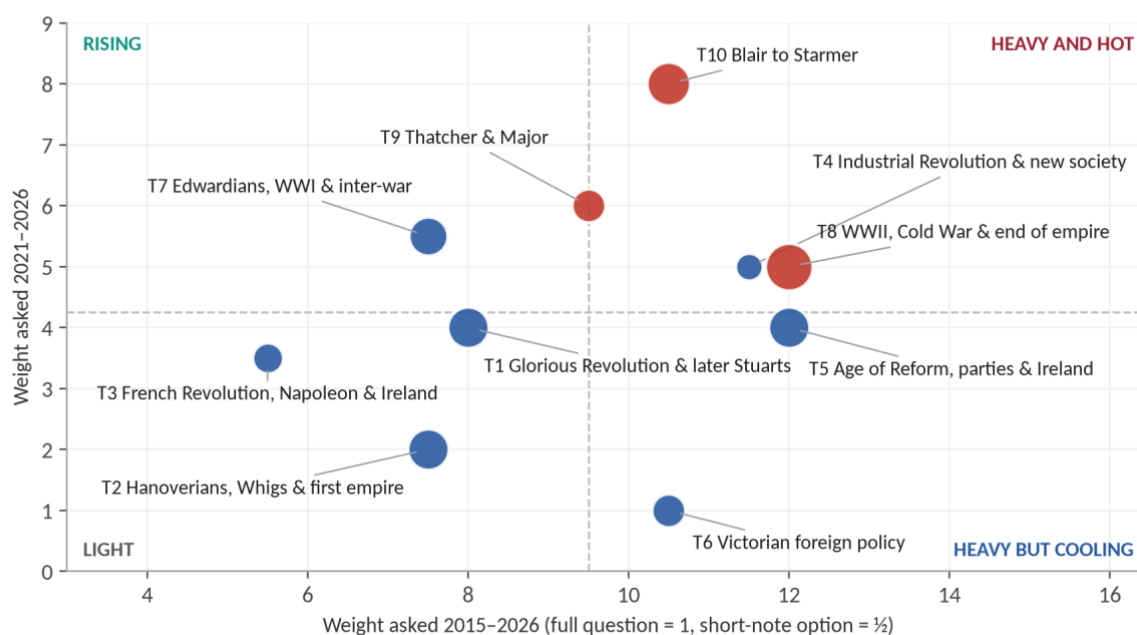


Figure 11 • Each topic's total weight (across) against its weight since 2021 (up). Topics top-right are heavy and still rising.

Tier 1 — prepare to full-answer depth from every angle

Topic	Families
T1	The Glorious Revolution — causes, nature ("so glorious"?), results at home and abroad
T2	Walpole and the Whig oligarchy — merits, demerits, downfall
T3	The French Revolution's influence and impact on Britain
T4	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution — causes, effects, "disruption or progress"; Methodism; Chartism
T5	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928; Peel; Gladstone's domestic policy and the Irish Question
T6	Splendid Isolation — why adopted, why ended
T7	The First World War — causes, effects on Britain, the decline of the Liberals and rise of Labour
T8	The Second World War and Churchill; decolonisation (with India 1947 and Suez); the Commonwealth
T9	Thatcherism; the Falklands; Britain and Europe to Maastricht
T10	New Labour; the War on Terror; the 2008 crisis; Cameron's reforms; Brexit

Tier 2 — prepare to a full plan and a short-note answer

Union of 1707 · Hanoverian succession · Chatham · American War · Union of 1801 · Palmerston · the Eastern Question, Crimea and Berlin · Disraeli's foreign policy · the League of Nations and inter-war foreign policy · Attlee's government · the special relationship · John Major · the ideas (Utilitarianism, Fabianism, Socialism, Liberalism) · abolition and empire.

Tier 3 — the blind spots most likely to be broken

The Napoleonic Wars and the Congress of Vienna · the Old Colonial System · free trade and the Corn Laws · Edwardian foreign policy and the ententes · the Treaty of Versailles · the Great Depression in Britain · appeasement and rearmament · the war conferences and the UN · NATO · Britain's entry into the EEC (1973) and the 1975 referendum · society and culture since 1960 · the Good Friday Agreement · the post-2016 governments (May to Starmer).

VERDICT · The strategy in one sentence

Master Tier 1 completely, plan Tier 2 fully, and learn Tier 3 to short-note level — because Section B leaves almost no choice, the leaks move topics between sections, and 2023 and 2026 both broke pattern.

Part Four — The Ten Topic Dossiers

HOW TO USE THIS • What a dossier is

Each dossier is a two-to-three-page briefing on one topic: the story in brief, what the syllabus asks for, **every question the examiner has set on it** (in full), what the record reveals, the blind spots, the core facts, and what the topic's two documents will contain. Read the dossier just before you open that topic's Knowledge Base.

T1 • The Glorious Revolution and the Later Stuarts, 1685–1714

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

A Catholic king, **James II**, tries to give Catholics equal rights by royal command in a Protestant country. When a Catholic heir is born in **1688**, the political class invites the Dutch Protestant **William of Orange** to invade. James flees; Parliament makes **William and Mary** joint monarchs and passes the **Bill of Rights**. Britain then fights Louis XIV's France in two great wars, wins a place among the great powers at **Utrecht (1713)**, and unites England and Scotland in **1707**. When Queen **Anne** dies in **1714**, the crown passes by law to the German House of **Hanover**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head I — the Glorious Revolution: causes and results; William III and Mary II (1689–1702); Queen Anne (1702–1714). **Head III** — the Union of England and Scotland.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P1 • Q2	What forced James II to issue the various Declarations of Indulgence?	The Glorious Revolution	Causes / results
2015 P1 • Q3	Account for the War of the League of Augsburg followed by the Treaty of Ryswick.	William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession)	Causes / results
2018 5A • Q2	What led to the occurrence of the ultra-degree of mega development towards the close of the 17th century in Britain known as the 'Glorious Revolution'?	The Glorious Revolution	Causes / results
2019 5A • Q2	What was so glorious about the Glorious Revolution? Discuss its significance in British history.	The Glorious Revolution	Impact / significance
2021 5A • Q2	What were the political and ideological differences among Non-Jurors, High Churchmen and Latitudinarians?	Church parties after 1688 (Non-Jurors, High Church, Latitudinarians)	Compare / contrast

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2021 §A · Q3	What were the political and constitutional causes and consequences of the Act of Union 1707?	Union of England and Scotland, 1707	Causes / results
2023 §A · Q2	How did the Glorious Revolution occur in Britain? What was its fallout at home and abroad?	The Glorious Revolution	Causes / results
2025 §A · Q2	Discuss the significance of Queen Anne's reign in shaping the course of the War of Spanish Succession and its impact on the balance of power in Europe.	William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession)	Impact / significance

What the record reveals

- **The Revolution itself is the core** — four questions (2015, 2018, 2019, 2023), each from a new angle: *what forced James* (2015), *what led to it* (2018), *what was so glorious* (2019), *how it happened and its fallout at home and abroad* (2023). Prepare causes, events, settlement, significance and the historians' debate as one block.
- **The wars are the second strand** — Augsburg and Ryswick (2015), Anne and the Spanish Succession (2025). Both are asked for their significance to Britain's place in Europe (the **balance of power**).
- **The unusual questions** — the Church parties after 1688 (2021) and the Union of 1707's *political and constitutional* causes and consequences (2021) — show the examiner reads the period deeply.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **William III's reign as a whole** — his domestic settlement and his foreign policy — has never been set.
- **The Act of Settlement (1701)** and the **Revolution Settlement** as a constitutional package.
- **Queen Anne's domestic politics** (Whigs against Tories; the Sacheverell affair, 1710).
- The Union of 1707 from the **Scottish** side (the Darien disaster, the Alien Act, the Act of Security).

The core in one page

- **People:** James II · William III · Mary II · Anne · Marlborough · Louis XIV · the "Immortal Seven" · Archbishop Sancroft · Godolphin · Harley and Bolingbroke · John Locke.
- **Dates:** Monmouth's rebellion **1685** · Declarations of Indulgence **1687** and **1688** · Seven Bishops acquitted **30 June 1688** · William lands **5 November 1688** · Bill of Rights **1689** · Toleration Act **1689** · the Boyne **1690** · Bank of England **1694** · Ryswick **1697** · Act of Settlement **1701** · Blenheim **1704** · Union **1707** · Utrecht **1713**.
- **Terms:** **divine right** · **dispensing and suspending powers** · **Glorious Revolution** · **Revolution Settlement** · **constitutional monarchy** · **Non-Jurors** · **Latitudinarians** · **balance of power** · **Act of Union 1707**.

What the T1 documents will carry

Maps: **the British Isles 1688–1692** (Torbay, the Boyne, Killiecrankie, Glencoe); **Europe in the wars against Louis XIV** (Blenheim, the gains of Utrecht). Figures: the **Stuart–Hanover family tree** (why the crown went to Hanover); a **time-line 1685–1714**; the **Revolution Settlement** as a diagram of what the Crown lost to Parliament. The T1 Knowledge Base also opens with the full **"ABC" section** for readers starting from zero.

VERDICT • Priority

Tier 1 for the Glorious Revolution (asked four times); **Tier 2** for the wars and the Union. Weight: **8%** of the descriptive record; **7 MCQs** in three years — one of the heaviest objective topics.

T2 • Hanoverian Britain, the Whig Oligarchy and the First Empire, 1714–1783

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

The German **George I** becomes king in **1714**. The Tories are suspected of wanting the exiled Stuarts back, so the **Whigs** rule for nearly fifty years. **Robert Walpole (1721–1742)** keeps the peace and manages Parliament. The Stuarts try twice to return by force — the **Jacobite risings** of **1715** and **1745** — and fail at **Culloden (1746)**. Meanwhile a trading empire grows on the **Old Colonial System** and the **slave trade**. **Pitt the Elder** wins the **Seven Years' War (1756–1763)**: Canada and dominance in India. But taxing the American colonists to pay for it leads to the **American War of Independence**, lost in **1783**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head II — the Hanoverian era (1714–1790): the Jacobite rebellions (1715 and 1745); Robert Walpole and the Whig oligarchy; the American War of Independence (1776). **Head V** — the Old Colonial System.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P1 • Q4	Evaluate analytically and critically the role of Walpole as Secretary of State, Prime Minister, party organiser and financier.	Walpole and the Whig oligarchy	Person
2015 P1 • Q5	Shed light on the American War of Independence with special reference to its debit side and credit side for Great Britain.	American War of Independence	Causes / results
2015 P1 • Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Jacobite Revolt of Scotland	The Jacobite risings	Short note
2017 §A • Q2	What were the merits and demerits of Whig rule? What led to the downfall of Whig ascendancy? Analyze comprehensively.	Walpole and the Whig oligarchy	Causes / results
2019 §A • Q3	What was the political and constitutional significance of the Hanoverian succession in England?	The Hanoverian succession	Impact / significance

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2020 §A · Q2	What are the merits and demerits of the Whig oligarchy? Critically examine the causes of the downfall of Whig ascendancy.	Walpole and the Whig oligarchy	Causes / results
2022 §A · Q3	'A glorious success until 1761 and then failure.' Do you agree with this estimate of the career of Chatham?	Pitt the Elder (Chatham)	Quotation / claim
2026 §A · Q2	Examine the complex relationships between abolition, imperialism, and economic interests, and argue for or against the notion that Britain's anti-slavery movement was a thinly veiled justification for colonial expansion.	Slavery, abolition and empire	How far / extent

What the record reveals

- **Walpole and the Whig oligarchy** is the core family (2015, 2017, 2020). Twice it has been asked in nearly the same words: *merits and demerits of Whig rule, and the causes of its downfall*. This is a near-certain return.
- **The Hanoverian succession's political and constitutional significance** (2019) — the link between T1 and T2: why the Act of Settlement and a foreign king strengthened Parliament and the Cabinet.
- **Chatham** (2022) through a historian's verdict: *"a glorious success until 1761 and then failure"*.
- **2026 Q2** opened a new line: **abolition, imperialism and economic interests** — using the Eric Williams debate.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **The Old Colonial System** (Head V) — never set. Mercantilism, the Navigation Acts, and why the system broke in America.
- **The Jacobite risings** as a full question (only a 2015 short note).
- **George III and the "King's Friends"** — the end of the Whig ascendancy after 1760.
- **The causes** of the American war as a question in themselves.

The core in one page

- **People:** George I, II, III · Walpole · the Pelhams · Pitt the Elder (Chatham) · Lord Bute · Lord North · James the Old Pretender · Charles Edward Stuart · Clive · Wolfe · Washington · Wilberforce.
- **Dates:** the '15 **1715** · Septennial Act **1716** · South Sea Bubble **1720** · Walpole **1721–42** · Excise crisis **1733** · the '45 and Culloden **1745–46** · Seven Years' War **1756–63** · Plassey **1757** · Stamp Act **1765** · Declaration of Independence **4 July 1776** · Saratoga **1777** · Yorktown **1781** · Treaty of Paris **1783** · slave trade abolished **1807**.
- **Terms:** **Whig oligarchy** · **patronage** · **Jacobitism** · **mercantilism** · **Navigation Acts** · **Old Colonial System** · **triangular trade** · **no taxation without representation** · **salutary neglect**.

What the T2 documents will carry

Maps: **the '45** (Glenfinnan → Derby → Culloden); **the world in 1763** (the gains of the Seven Years' War); **the Thirteen Colonies and the American war**; **the Atlantic triangular trade**. Figures: the Hanoverian family tree; Walpole's system as a diagram; a causes-of-the-American-Revolution flow chart.

VERDICT • Priority

Tier 1 for Walpole and the Whigs; **Tier 2** for the succession, Chatham, America and abolition; **Tier 3** for the Old Colonial System and the Jacobites. Weight **8%**; **7 MCQs** — as heavy as T1 in the objective paper.

T3 • Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland, 1783–1815

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

William Pitt the Younger becomes Prime Minister at 24 in **1783** and restores Britain's finances. In **1789** the **French Revolution** breaks out. British opinion divides — **Burke** against, **Paine** for — and when France declares war in **1793**, Pitt's government clamps down on radicals at home. Ireland rebels in **1798**; Pitt's answer is the **Act of Union of 1801**. **Nelson** wins at sea (**Trafalgar, 1805**), **Wellington** on land (the **Peninsula**, then **Waterloo, 1815**), and at the **Congress of Vienna** Britain emerges as the world's leading power.

What the syllabus asks for

Head IV — the Union of England and Ireland. **Head VI** — the French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars: causes; Britain and the Napoleonic Wars; impact on Britain.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2016 §A • Q2	What measures were adopted by England to check the influence of the French Revolution of 1789 on England?	The French Revolution and Britain	Policy analysis
2020 §A • Q3	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	The French Revolution and Britain	Impact / significance
2022 §A • Q5	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	The French Revolution and Britain	Impact / significance
2023 §A • Q3	'The English people got so much frightened by the developments in France that there prevailed a sort of panic across the country.' Analyse the after-effects of the French Revolution on England.	The French Revolution and Britain	Quotation / claim

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2025 §A · Q3	Analyze the controversies surrounding the Act of Union 1801, focusing on the differing perspectives of Irish and British politicians. Assess its impact on Irish nationalism and the stability of the United Kingdom.	Union with Ireland, 1801	How far / extent
2025 §B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society	The French Revolution and Britain	Short note

What the record reveals

- **One family dominates: the Revolution's influence on Britain** — five items (2016, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2025). The question is always about **Britain**, never about France: the panic, the repression, Burke and Paine, radical societies, the war economy, and long-term effects on reform.
- **2020 Q3 and 2022 Q5 are word for word the same.** A third appearance of this exact wording would surprise no one.
- **The Union of 1801** (2025) was asked as a *controversy*: Irish and British perspectives, Irish nationalism, the stability of the UK — a question that bridges T3 and T5.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Britain and the Napoleonic Wars** — the fighting, the strategy (sea power, coalitions, subsidies), the Continental System, the Peninsular War, Waterloo — has **never** been set, although it is a named sub-head. It is the most likely surprise in Part I.
- **The Congress of Vienna** and Castlereagh.
- **Pitt the Younger** as a Prime Minister: finance, reform, war.

The core in one page

- **People:** Pitt the Younger · Charles James Fox · Edmund Burke · Thomas Paine · Mary Wollstonecraft · Wolfe Tone · Nelson · Wellington · Napoleon · Castlereagh.
- **Dates:** Pitt PM **1783** · Revolution **1789** · Burke's *Reflections* **1790** · Paine's *Rights of Man* **1791–92** · war **1 February 1793** · habeas corpus suspended **1794** · Two Acts **1795** · Irish rising **1798** · Combination Acts **1799–1800** · Union **1 January 1801** · Trafalgar **21 October 1805** · Peninsular War **1808–14** · Waterloo **18 June 1815** · Vienna **1815**.
- **Terms:** **Jacobin** · **radicalism** · **habeas corpus** · **Combination Acts** · **United Irishmen** · **Continental System** · **Concert of Europe**.

What the T3 documents will carry

Maps: **Napoleonic Europe at its height (1812)**; **the campaigns** (Nile, Trafalgar, the Peninsula, Waterloo); **Ireland in 1798**; **Europe after Vienna (1815)**. Figures: the Burke–Paine debate as a two-column diagram; the chain from Revolution to repression to reform.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1 for the Revolution's influence on Britain; **Tier 2** for the Union of 1801; **Tier 3** (high risk) for the Napoleonic Wars. Weight **6%** — the lightest topic, but with the most exact repeat in the whole record.

T4 · The Industrial and Agricultural Revolutions and the New Society, c.1750–1900

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Between about **1750** and **1850** Britain became the first industrial nation. New farming and **enclosure** fed more people and pushed labourers into towns. **Coal, iron, steam and cotton** created factories and cities like **Manchester**; canals and then **railways** tied the country together. Life for workers was hard and dangerous. People answered this new world with new beliefs and movements: **Methodism** brought religion to the poor; **Utilitarians** and **Liberals** argued for reform and free markets; **Socialists** and later the **Fabians** for collective action; and the **Chartists** (**1838–1848**) demanded the vote for working men.

What the syllabus asks for

Head VII — Industrial and Agricultural Revolution: causes; effects on political and social life; party politics; the Methodist Movement; Socialism; Liberalism; Colonization; the Chartist Movement.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P1 · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Industrial Revolution	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	Short note
2015 P1 · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Methodist Movement	The Methodist Movement	Short note
2015 P2 · Q3	Describe the emergence of the Methodist Movement in England. What were its good and bad effects on the people?	The Methodist Movement	Causes / results
2016 §B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Fabianism	Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism	Short note
2017 §A · Q3	The Industrial Revolution drastically changed methods of production in England. How did it affect the social, economic, political and cultural life of the English people?	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	Impact / significance
2017 §A · Q4	Give a comprehensive account of the Chartist Movement. Why did it fail? Explain and analyse.	Chartism	Causes / results

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2018 §A · Q3	'The 18th century witnessed the emergence, rise and growth of two movements (Agrarian and Industrial) which revolutionised the lives of the English people in particular and later the world in general.' Comment on the statement.	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	Quotation / claim
2019 §A · Q4	Explain the factors that led to the Industrial Revolution and discuss how it affected the social, political, economic and cultural life of the English people.	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	Causes / results
2022 §B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Utilitarianism	Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism	Short note
2024 §A · Q3	Describe the reasons due to which millions of people united in support of the Chartist Movement in the mid-19th century to attain democratic rights for the working classes.	Chartism	Causes / results
2024 §A · Q4	How did the Methodist Movement begin? Also explain its salient features and reasons for success.	The Methodist Movement	Causes / results
2025 §A · Q5	Compare and contrast the ideologies of Socialism and Liberalism in Britain during the 19th century, examining their differing approaches to issues such as economic inequality, social justice and the role of the state.	Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism	Compare / contrast
2025 §B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Methodist Movement	The Methodist Movement	Short note
2026 §A · Q3	Critically evaluate the extent to which the Industrial Revolution transformed British society more through disruption than through progress. Use regional examples to support your argument.	The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution	How far / extent

What the record reveals

- **This is the most-asked topic by number of items (14).** Three families: the **Industrial Revolution** (5), **Methodism** (4) and **Chartism** (2), plus the **ideas** (3).
- **The Industrial Revolution** has been asked for its causes and its effects on "social, economic, political and cultural life" (2017, 2019) — the same four areas each time — and in **2026** as a historians' debate: *more disruption than progress? Use regional examples.*
- **Methodism** has been asked for its emergence, effects, features and reasons for success — and set as a short note twice.
- **Chartism** has been asked for why it failed (2017) and why millions supported it (2024): prepare both.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **The Agricultural Revolution** on its own (enclosure, Tull, Townshend, Bakewell).
- **Colonization** (named in the syllabus, never asked).
- **Utilitarianism's influence on reform** (Bentham, Chadwick, the Poor Law) as a full question.
- **The factory reform movement** (Factory Acts 1833, 1844, 1847).

The core in one page

- **People:** John Wesley · George Whitefield · James Watt · Richard Arkwright · George Stephenson · Jeremy Bentham · J. S. Mill · Robert Owen · Feargus O'Connor · William Lovett · Sidney and Beatrice Webb.
- **Dates:** Wesley's conversion **1738** · Watt's patent **1769** · Arkwright's Cromford mill **1771** · Liverpool–Manchester railway **1830** · Factory Act **1833** · Tolpuddle Martyrs **1834** · People's Charter **1838** · Newport Rising **1839** · Kennington Common **10 April 1848** · Great Exhibition **1851** · Fabian Society **1884**.
- **Terms:** **enclosure** · **factory system** · **laissez-faire** · **Methodism** · **the Halévy thesis** · **Utilitarianism** · **Chartism** (the six points) · **Fabianism** · **Owenite socialism**.

What the T4 documents will carry

Maps: **industrial Britain c.1850** (coalfields, textile and iron districts, canals and the first railways); **Chartist Britain** (Newport, Birmingham, Manchester, Kennington). Figures: the causes of the Industrial Revolution as a web; population and urban growth charts; the six points of the Charter and when each was granted; the family tree of the ideas (Liberalism → Utilitarianism → Socialism → Fabianism).

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1 throughout. Weight **12%** — the third-heaviest. Only **2 MCQs** so far, but the descriptive weight makes this a must-master topic.

T5 · The Age of Reform: Parliament, Parties, Peel, Gladstone and Ireland, 1815–1928

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

After Waterloo the old Parliament — with its **rotten boroughs** and tiny electorate — faced a nation that had changed. Repression (**Peterloo, 1819**) gave way to reform: Catholic Emancipation (**1829**), the **Great Reform Act (1832)** and a decade of reforming laws. **Peel** built the **Conservative Party**, then split it by repealing the **Corn Laws (1846)**. Out of the wreck came **Gladstone's** Liberals and **Disraeli's** Conservatives, who took turns to widen the vote (**1867, 1884**) and reform the state. Gladstone's great cause was **Ireland**; his **Home Rule** Bills failed in **1886** and **1893**. The story ends with votes for women (**1918, 1928**) and the Irish Free State (**1922**).

What the syllabus asks for

Head VIII — Robert Peel and the return of the Tories: internal policies; the Irish problem.
Head IX (home) — Victorian internal reforms; the Liberals; Disraeli, Gladstone and the problems in Ireland; Great Britain and free trade. With **party politics** from Head VII.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P1 • Q6	The short reign of William IV is considered to be the long era of bills and acts. Substantiate the statement with supportive arguments.	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	Quotation / claim
2016 §A • Q3	Analyze critically the Reform Act of 1832.	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	Impact / significance
2017 §A • Q5	'Gladstone's domestic policy was the climax of liberalism.' Discuss comprehensively.	Gladstone's domestic policy	Quotation / claim
2018 §A • Q4	Shed ample light on the interior as well as exterior policy of Sir Robert Peel as British Premier, with particular emphasis on the Irish issue.	Sir Robert Peel	Policy analysis
2018 §A • Q5	What measures were taken for the democratisation of the British Parliament over the decades?	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	Describe / account
2019 §A • Q5	The Reform Act of 1832 made possible the series of political and administrative reforms that laid the foundation of modern Britain. Discuss.	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	Quotation / claim
2020 §A • Q4	Give a history of parliamentary reforms between 1832 and 1928. Also critically examine how England became a politically democratic country.	Parliamentary reform 1832–1928	Describe / account
2020 §A • Q5	'Peel was the most liberal of conservatives and the most conservative of liberals.' Examine the statement critically.	Sir Robert Peel	Quotation / claim
2022 §A • Q2	The domestic policy of Gladstone was the climax of liberalism during the 19th century. Discuss and analyze.	Gladstone's domestic policy	Quotation / claim
2024 §A • Q1	How far did Robert Peel's methods of governance differ from those of his predecessors, viz. Liverpool, Canning and Wellington?	Sir Robert Peel	Compare / contrast
2024 §A • Q2	Define the 'Irish Question'. Also discuss the policy of the Liberal Party on the said issue from 1886 to 1894.	The Irish Question and Home Rule	Policy analysis
2025 §A • Q4	Examine the evolution of party politics in Britain during the 19th century, focusing on the rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties, and the changing relationship between government, parliament and the electorate.	Rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties	Describe / account

What the record reveals

- **This is the heaviest topic by weight** (12 full questions). Three families lead: **parliamentary reform** (5), **Peel** (3) and **Gladstone's domestic policy** (2, the same quotation).
- **Reform** has been asked as the 1832 Act (2016, 2019), the whole road to democracy (2018, 2020: 1832–1928) and William IV's reforming decade (2015). Prepare one master time-line of every Act and what it changed.
- **Peel** has been asked three ways — his policies, a quotation, and a comparison with **Liverpool, Canning and Wellington** (2024).
- **Ireland** entered through the **Liberal policy of 1886–1894** (2024), and **party politics** through the rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties (2025).

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Disraeli's domestic policy** ("Tory democracy", the 1867 Act, the social reforms of 1874–80).
- **Free trade** and the Anti-Corn Law League — a named sub-head, never set.
- **The Irish Famine (1845–1849)** and its political effects.
- **The suffrage movement** and votes for women.

The core in one page

- **People:** Lord Liverpool · Canning · Wellington · Earl Grey · William IV · Peel · Cobden and Bright · Daniel O'Connell · Gladstone · Disraeli · Parnell · Emmeline Pankhurst.
- **Dates:** Peterloo **1819** · Catholic Emancipation **1829** · Reform Act **1832** · slavery abolished **1833** · New Poor Law **1834** · Tamworth Manifesto **1834** · Corn Laws repealed **1846** · Second Reform Act **1867** · Irish Church disestablished **1869** · Education Act **1870** · Ballot Act **1872** · Third Reform Act **1884** · Home Rule Bills **1886** and **1893** · Parliament Act **1911** · women over 30 vote **1918** · Irish Free State **1922** · equal franchise **1928**.
- **Terms:** **rotten and pocket boroughs** · **franchise** · **Tamworth Manifesto** · **Corn Laws** · **Peelites** · **Gladstonian Liberalism** ("peace, retrenchment and reform") · **Tory democracy** · **Home Rule**.

What the T5 documents will carry

Maps: **rotten boroughs against the new industrial towns in 1832**; **Ireland 1845–1922** (the Famine's toll by county, Ulster, partition). Figures: the franchise ladder 1832–1928 (share of adults able to vote); a Peel-versus-predecessors comparison table; the two-party system's family tree (Whig → Liberal; Tory → Conservative; the Peelite split).

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1. Weight **13%** — joint heaviest. **7 MCQs**. The reform time-line alone answers five past questions.

T6 · Victorian Britain and the World: Palmerston to Splendid Isolation, 1815–1907

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Victorian Britain wanted three things abroad: a **balance of power** in Europe so that no single state dominated, **safe sea routes to India**, and **free trade** everywhere. **Palmerston** defended these interests with loud words and gunboats. The slow decline of the **Ottoman Empire** — the **Eastern Question** — brought war with Russia in the **Crimea (1854–1856)** and, under **Disraeli**, the **Congress of Berlin (1878)**. **Gladstone** preferred morality and the Concert of Europe. At the end of the century Britain stood apart from Europe's alliances — **Splendid Isolation** — until Germany's rise pushed it into agreements with **Japan (1902)**, **France (1904)** and **Russia (1907)**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head IX — Victorian foreign policy (and Disraeli and Gladstone). **Head X** — Edwardian foreign policy (1901–1910).

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P1 • Q7	'Palmerston was at once a Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither a Whig nor a Tory.' Elucidate.	Palmerston	Quotation / claim
2015 P2 • Q2	Palmerston was conservative at home and liberal abroad. Discuss and conclude with arguments.	Palmerston	Quotation / claim
2015 P2 • Q4	Analyze the characters and policies of Gladstone and Disraeli with special reference to foreign affairs.	Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad	Compare / contrast
2015 P2 • Q5	What was the background in the context of which the Crimean War broke out? Discuss and analyze the results that followed the cessation of hostilities.	The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin	Causes / results
2015 P2 • Q7	Why did Britain adopt the Policy of Splendid Isolation from 1870 onwards in external affairs? How was this policy abandoned by the end of the 19th century? Discuss and analyze.	Splendid Isolation and its end	Causes / results
2016 §A • Q4	'Lord Palmerston was more successful as Foreign Minister than as Prime Minister.' Critically analyze.	Palmerston	Quotation / claim
2016 §A • Q5	Explain the policy of Disraeli with special reference to 'Peace with Honour'.	Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad	Policy analysis
2016 §B • Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Treaty of Berlin	The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin	Short note
2017 §B • Q6	Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.	The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin	Policy analysis
2018 §B • Q6	How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What were its positive and negative aspects?	Splendid Isolation and its end	Causes / results
2023 §A • Q4	Why did Britain initiate the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What is your personal opinion whether it was a right step in the right direction or proved detrimental?	Splendid Isolation and its end	How far / extent

What the record reveals

- **Four families, all asked often** until 2018: **Palmerston** (three quotations to evaluate, 2015–2016), **Gladstone against Disraeli** abroad (2015, 2016 — "Peace with Honour"), **the Eastern Question** (Crimea 2015, Berlin 2016, the whole question 1820–1913 in 2017) and **Splendid Isolation** (2015, 2018, 2023).
- **Splendid Isolation is the living family** — the only one set after 2018. It has been asked *why adopted* (twice) and *how ended* (once), with a demand for the student's own opinion in 2023.

- **The quiet since 2018 is a warning, not a comfort.** This topic supplied ten items between 2015 and 2018; it will return.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Castlereagh and Canning** (1815–1827) — the Congress system and Canning's break with it.
- **The Scramble for Africa and the Boer War** — imperialism as a question in itself.
- **The Great Game** in Central Asia (asked as a 2024 MCQ).
- **Gladstone's foreign policy** on its own (Alabama arbitration, Egypt, Gordon).

The core in one page

- **People:** Castlereagh · Canning · Palmerston · Disraeli · Gladstone · Lord Salisbury · Joseph Chamberlain · Lord Lansdowne · Edward Grey · Nicholas I · Bismarck.
- **Dates:** Belgian independence guaranteed **1839** · Opium War **1839–42** · Don Pacifico **1850** · Crimean War **1854–56** · Treaty of Paris **1856** · Indian Mutiny **1857** · Suez Canal opens **1869** · Suez shares **1875** · Royal Titles Act **1876** · San Stefano and Berlin **1878** · Egypt occupied **1882** · Boer War **1899–1902** · Anglo-Japanese Alliance **1902** · Entente Cordiale **1904** · Anglo-Russian Convention **1907**.
- **Terms:** **balance of power** · **Concert of Europe** · **gunboat diplomacy** · **Civis Romanus sum** · **Eastern Question** · **Straits question** · **Peace with Honour** · **Splendid Isolation** · **Entente**.

What the T6 documents will carry

Maps: **the Eastern Question** (the Ottoman Empire, the Straits, the Crimea); **the Balkans in 1878** (San Stefano against Berlin, side by side); **the route to India** (Gibraltar, Malta, Suez, Aden); **Africa in 1914**; **Europe's alliances in 1907**. Figures: Palmerston's principles; Gladstone against Disraeli comparison table; the end of Splendid Isolation as a three-step timeline.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1 for Splendid Isolation; **Tier 2** for Palmerston, the Eastern Question and Disraeli abroad (quiet, therefore due). Weight **11%**; **4 MCQs**.

T7 · Edwardian Britain, the Great War and the Road to 1939

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Edward VII (1901–1910) reigned over a confident but troubled country. The **Liberals** won a landslide in **1906** and began the welfare state (pensions, National Insurance); **Lloyd George's** budget led to the **Parliament Act** of **1911**, which cut the power of the Lords. The new **Labour Party** entered Parliament. In **1914** Britain went to war with Germany. The **Great War** cost about three-quarters of a million British lives, changed society for ever and broke the Liberal Party. After the **Treaty of Versailles** and the **League of Nations**, Britain faced depression and, in the 1930s, the dictators. **Chamberlain** tried **appeasement** until Hitler invaded Poland in **1939**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head X — the Edwardian era: domestic and foreign policies (1901–1910); the origins of the Labour Party. **Head XI** — Britain, World War I and its aftermath: causes; the peace settlement; effects of the war on Britain; the League of Nations; the Great Depression; appeasement and rearmament.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P2 · Q8	Describe and critically analyze the foreign policy of England from 1919 to 1939.	Inter-war foreign policy and the League	Policy analysis
2020 §B · Q7	What do you know about the League of Nations? Explain the work of the League. What were the causes of its failure?	Inter-war foreign policy and the League	Causes / results
2021 §A · Q4	Provide a detailed account of the causes of World War I and its effects on the social and economic aspects of Britain.	The First World War and its effects	Causes / results
2021 §A · Q5	What is the Edwardian era? Elucidate the rise and significance of the Labour Movement in the Edwardian era.	Edwardian era and the rise of Labour	Describe / account
2022 §A · Q4	Discuss the rise of the Labour Party in Britain and enumerate the achievements of this party.	Edwardian era and the rise of Labour	Describe / account
2022 §B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Lord Kitchener	The First World War and its effects	Short note
2023 §A · Q5	According to Rudyard Kipling, 'however the world pretends to divide itself, there are only two divisions in the world today — human beings and Germans.' In the light of this statement, was British policy in the First World War justified or not? Comment.	The First World War and its effects	Quotation / claim
2026 §A · Q5	Critically evaluate the effects of World War I on British social structure, industrial relations, and the polity, highlighting the ways in which the war accelerated the decline of the Liberal Party and paved the way for Labour's rise to power.	The First World War and its effects	Impact / significance

What the record reveals

- **The First World War is the core** — its causes and effects (2021), British policy judged through **Kipling** (2023), and its effects on society, industrial relations and politics, including **the decline of the Liberals and the rise of Labour** (2026). Kitchener appeared as a short note (2022).
- **The Labour Party's rise** has been set twice in two years (2021, 2022). With 2026's Liberal-decline question, this is a family on the boil.
- **The inter-war years** have been asked only twice (foreign policy 1919–39 in 2015; the League in 2020).

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Appeasement and rearmament** — a named sub-head, never set since 2015, and the most famous controversy of the period.
- **The Treaty of Versailles and Britain's role** in the peace settlement.
- **The Great Depression in Britain** (1929–1933: the National Government, the end of the gold standard, the hungry thirties).
- **The Liberal reforms of 1906–1914** and the Parliament Act crisis.

The core in one page

- **People:** Edward VII · Campbell-Bannerman · Asquith · Lloyd George · Keir Hardie · Ramsay MacDonald · Edward Grey · Kitchener · Haig · Baldwin · Chamberlain · Churchill (in the 1930s).
- **Dates:** LRC founded **1900** · Taff Vale **1901** · Liberal landslide **1906** · pensions **1908** · People's Budget **1909** · Parliament Act **1911** · war declared **4 August 1914** · conscription **1916** · the Somme **1 July 1916** · Representation of the People Act **1918** · Armistice **11 November 1918** · Versailles **28 June 1919** · first Labour government **1924** · General Strike **1926** · National Government **1931** · Munich **30 September 1938** · war **3 September 1939**.
- **Terms:** **Edwardian era** · **New Liberalism** · **Lib-Lab pact** · **Taff Vale judgment** · **DORA** · **total war** · **collective security** · **appeasement** · **rearmament**.

What the T7 documents will carry

Maps: **Europe in 1914** (the two alliance blocs); **the Western Front**; **Europe after Versailles (1919–23)**; **Hitler's expansion 1936–39** (Rhineland, Austria, Sudetenland, Prague, Poland). Figures: the causes of WWI as a long-term/short-term/trigger diagram; Liberal and Labour seats 1900–1935 (the crossover); the appeasement debate as for-and-against columns.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1 for WWI and Labour; **Tier 3** (high risk) for appeasement and Versailles. Weight **8%**; **6 MCQs**.

T8 • The Second World War, Attlee, the Cold War and the End of Empire, 1939–1979

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Churchill led Britain from **1940** through Dunkirk, the Battle of Britain and the Blitz to victory in **1945**, alongside the USA and the USSR. The **war conferences** and the **United Nations** shaped the peace. **Attlee's** Labour government built the **welfare state** and the **NHS**. The **Cold War** made Britain America's closest ally (NATO, **1949**). The **Empire** came to an end: India and Pakistan in **1947**, Palestine in **1948**, humiliation at **Suez** in **1956**, Africa in the 1960s. Britain turned to **Europe**, joining the EEC in **1973**, and struggled with inflation and strikes until the **Winter of Discontent** of **1978–79**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head XII — Britain, World War II and its aftermath: causes and events; Churchill and the war conferences; the creation of the UNO; effects of the war; reforms of the Labour government.

Head XIII — Great Britain and the Cold War: the creation of the Commonwealth; NATO; decolonisation of the British Empire; internal policies and the EEC; foreign policy.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2015 P2 • Q6	How has the idea of the British Commonwealth of Nations developed? In what ways does its significance differ from the term British Empire?	The Commonwealth	Compare / contrast
2016 §B • Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Second World War	The Second World War and Churchill	Short note
2017 §B • Q7	What do you understand by the British Commonwealth of Nations and how did it develop? How does it differ from the term British Empire?	The Commonwealth	Compare / contrast
2018 §B • Q7	Why is it believed in certain circles that after decolonisation Britain was subservient to the US line of action during the Cold War and thereafter, down to 9/11 and subsequent years? Do you agree or not? Argue.	The special relationship with the USA	How far / extent
2018 §B • Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Sir Winston Churchill	The Second World War and Churchill	Short note
2019 §B • Q6	How successfully did the Labour government of 1945–51 tackle the economic and social problems of post-World War II Britain?	Attlee's Labour government 1945–51	How far / extent
2019 §B • Q7	What were the motives behind Britain's move to decolonisation after 1945? Also explain why and how the British left India in 1947.	Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	Causes / results
2020 §B • Q6	What do you know about the Middle East and Suez Canal Crisis? Also explain why England withdrew from Palestine and the Suez Canal. Discuss.	Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	Causes / results

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2022 §B · Q7	Discuss Winston Churchill as a statesman, warrior and a man of letters.	The Second World War and Churchill	Person
2022 §B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Suez Canal Crisis	Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	Short note
2023 §B · Q6	Produce an analytical essay on the causes, major developments and aftermath of the Second World War.	The Second World War and Churchill	Causes / results
2024 §B · Q6	How did World War II and the Cold War trigger the decolonization of the British Empire?	Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	Causes / results
2024 §B · Q7(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Creation of the Commonwealth	The Commonwealth	Short note
2026 §A · Q4	How far was the decline of the British Empire after 1945 the result of global pressures rather than internal political decisions? Support your analysis with at least three major real end-of-decolonisation cases.	Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez	How far / extent

What the record reveals

- **Decolonisation is the dominant family** — five items (2019, 2020, 2022, 2024, 2026). It has been asked through India (2019), Palestine and Suez (2020, 2022), WWII and the Cold War as triggers (2024), and **global pressures against internal decisions, with three real cases** (2026).
- **The Commonwealth** — its development and difference from the Empire — has been set twice in almost the same words (2015, 2017), plus a short note (2024).
- **WWII and Churchill** (four items) and **Attlee's government** (2019) complete the core; **the special relationship** (2018) is the link to T9 and T10.

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **The war conferences** (Tehran, Yalta, Potsdam) and **the creation of the UN** — never set.
- **NATO** and Britain's Cold War foreign policy.
- **Britain's road into Europe** (1961, 1963, 1967, 1973, 1975).
- **Home policies 1951–1979** — "never had it so good", the 1960s, the 1970s crises.

The core in one page

- **People:** Churchill · Attlee · Bevin · Bevan · Beveridge · Eden · Macmillan · Wilson · Heath · Callaghan · Mountbatten · Jinnah · Nehru · Nasser · de Gaulle.
- **Dates:** Churchill PM **10 May 1940** · Dunkirk **May–June 1940** · Beveridge Report **1942** · D-Day **6 June 1944** · Yalta **February 1945** · UN Charter **1945** · Labour landslide **July 1945** · independence **14–15 August 1947** · Palestine left **May 1948** · NHS **5 July 1948** · NATO **4 April 1949** · London Declaration **1949** · Suez **1956** · Ghana **1957** · "wind of change" **1960** · EEC entry **1 January 1973** · referendum **1975** · Winter of Discontent **1978–79**.

- **Terms:** **total war** · **Beveridge's five giants** · **welfare state** · **nationalisation** · **special relationship** · **containment** · **decolonisation** · **Commonwealth** · **wind of change** · **post-war consensus** ("Butskellism").

What the T8 documents will carry

Maps: **Europe at war 1942**; **the partition of India, 1947**; **Palestine 1947–48**; **Suez 1956**; **decolonisation by date** (a world map coloured by year of independence); **NATO and the Warsaw Pact**. Figures: Beveridge's five giants and the Acts that answered them; the three levels of decolonisation (international, British, colonial); the Commonwealth's growth.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1. Weight **13%** — joint heaviest — and the **heaviest objective topic (10 MCQs)**. In Section B it cannot be avoided.

T9 · Thatcher and Major: Thatcherism, the Falklands and Europe, 1979–1997

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Margaret Thatcher came to power in **1979** promising to reverse Britain's decline. She fought inflation, cut the unions' power (defeating the **miners' strike** of **1984–85**), sold state industries and council houses, and reformed education. She won the **Falklands War** in **1982** and stood with Reagan as the Cold War ended — but her hostility to European integration and the **poll tax** led her party to remove her in **1990**. **John Major** signed the **Maastricht Treaty** (**1992**), won a surprise election, then lost authority after **Black Wednesday** and a party split over Europe, and was swept away by Blair in **1997**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head XIV (first half) — internal policy; society and culture; foreign policy; the Falklands War; John Major and his policies; the European Common Market and Great Britain; the formation of the EU.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2016 §B · Q6	'Margaret Thatcher is judged to be the best post-war Prime Minister of England.' Discuss.	Thatcher and Thatcherism	Quotation / claim
2018 §B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Britain's role in the EU	Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)	Short note
2019 §B · Q8	Explain why John Major and the Conservatives won the general election of 1992 but lost the election of 1997.	John Major	Causes / results
2020 §B · Q8	What were the causes of the Falkland War? In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?	The Falklands War	Causes / results

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2021 §B · Q6	What was the Falkland Islands conflict? Why did the British invade the Falkland Islands and how did this war come to an end?	The Falklands War	Causes / results
2021 §B · Q7	What was the contribution of Great Britain to the formation of the European Common Market and the European Union? Also highlight its impact on the foreign policy of Britain.	Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)	Policy analysis
2022 §B · Q6	Explain the genesis of the Falkland War. How has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?	The Falklands War	Causes / results
2024 §B · Q5	Define the term 'Thatcherism'. Discuss Margaret Thatcher's economic and educational reforms and their impacts on people's lives.	Thatcher and Thatcherism	Policy analysis
2024 §B · Q7(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Falkland War	The Falklands War	Short note
2026 §B · Q6	Discuss the impact of European integration on British politics and identity since 1973, with particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro.	Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)	Impact / significance
2026 §B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> John Major's foreign policy	John Major	Short note

What the record reveals

- **The Falklands War is the most-repeated modern family** — three full questions in three consecutive years (2020, 2021, 2022) and a short note (2024). Twice the question has asked about **relations with Latin America** afterwards.
- **Thatcher** has been asked as a judgement ("the best post-war PM", 2016) and as a definition plus policies (**economic and educational reforms**, 2024).
- **Britain and Europe** runs through T8, T9 and T10: the contribution to the Common Market and the EU (2021), a short note (2018) and **European integration since 1973, Maastricht and the euro opt-out** (2026).
- **John Major**: why he won in 1992 and lost in 1997 (2019), and his foreign policy (2026 short note).

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Society and culture in the 1980s** (a named sub-head).
- **Thatcher's foreign policy** as a whole (the Cold War, Reagan, Gorbachev, Hong Kong, South Africa).
- **Northern Ireland from 1979 to 1997** (hunger strikes, Brighton, the Anglo-Irish Agreement, the Downing Street Declaration).
- **The miners' strike** and the trade union laws.

The core in one page

- **People:** Margaret Thatcher · Geoffrey Howe · Nigel Lawson · Arthur Scargill · Michael Heseltine · Galtieri · Reagan · Gorbachev · Jacques Delors · John Major · Norman Lamont.
- **Dates:** Thatcher PM **4 May 1979** · Argentine invasion **2 April 1982** · *Belgrano* sunk **2 May 1982** · Stanley surrenders **14 June 1982** · miners' strike **March 1984 – March**

1985 · Single European Act **1986** · Big Bang **1986** · Education Reform Act **1988** · Bruges speech **1988** · Thatcher resigns **22 November 1990** · Maastricht **1992** · election **9 April 1992** · Black Wednesday **16 September 1992** · Labour landslide **1 May 1997**.

- **Terms: Thatcherism · monetarism · privatisation · Right to Buy · the enemy within · Total Exclusion Zone · Single European Act · ERM · opt-out · Euroscepticism.**

What the T9 documents will carry

Maps: **the Falklands War** (South Atlantic, the Exclusion Zone, the *Belgrano*, San Carlos, Goose Green, Stanley); **the coalfields of the miners' strike**; **the European Community's enlargement 1973–1995**. Figures: inflation and unemployment under Thatcher; privatisations time-line; the Maastricht "three pillars" and the opt-outs.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1. Weight **10%**; **4 MCQs**. The Falklands and Europe are the likeliest Section-B choices after decolonisation.

T10 · Blair to Burnham: New Labour, the War on Terror, Crisis and Brexit, 1997–2026

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS

Tony Blair's New Labour won in **1997** with a promise of modernisation: devolution, peace in Northern Ireland (**1998**), an independent Bank of England and heavy investment in public services. After **9/11** Blair joined the USA in **Afghanistan** and **Iraq (2003)** — the most divisive decision of the era. **Gordon Brown** faced the **2008 financial crisis**. **David Cameron's** coalition imposed austerity and reformed welfare, schools and marriage law, then lost the **EU referendum** of **2016**. **May** and **Johnson** delivered **Brexit (2020)**; Johnson led through the pandemic; **Elizabeth II** died in **2022**; **Truss** fell after 49 days; **Sunak** steadied the ship; and **Starmer** won a landslide in **2024**.

What the syllabus asks for

Head XIV (second half) — Tony Blair, "New Labour", the economic crunch, the War on Terror and his policies; the Global Financial Crisis 2008 and Great Britain; reforms under Cameron. These notes extend the topic to **2026**.

What the examiner has asked

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2016 §B · Q7	Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron with special reference to the Middle East.	David Cameron	Policy analysis
2017 §B · Q8	What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments.	Brexit	Impact / significance

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2018 §B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana	Diana, Princess of Wales	Short note
2021 §B · Q8	What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror? How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?	The War on Terror	Policy analysis
2023 §B · Q7	'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.	The War on Terror	Quotation / claim
2023 §B · Q8	How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession in the 21st century and how did it respond?	The 2008 financial crisis	Causes / results
2024 §B · Q7(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under David Cameron	David Cameron	Short note
2025 §B · Q6	How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments? Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?	Blair and New Labour	How far / extent
2025 §B · Q7	How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society? How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ, and what were their long-term effects?	The 2008 financial crisis	Impact / significance
2025 §B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under Cameron Government	David Cameron	Short note
2026 §B · Q7	From 1997 to 2012, Britain saw dramatic shifts in foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity. Assess whether the period should be interpreted as one of renewal or of unresolved contradictions in British governance.	Blair and New Labour	How far / extent
2026 §B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Britain's role in the War on Terror	The War on Terror	Short note
2026 §B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana Spencer	Diana, Princess of Wales	Short note

What the record reveals

- **The newest topic is the fastest-rising:** 8 of its 10.5 weighted items came in **2021–2026**, and it was asked in every paper from 2023 to 2026.
- **Four families lead:** the **War on Terror** (2021, 2023, 2026 sn), **the 2008 crisis** (2023, 2025), **New Labour** (2025, 2026 — both judgement questions) and **Cameron** (2016 foreign policy; **reforms** as short notes in 2024 and 2025).
- **Brexit** was asked in 2017, a year after the referendum. **Diana** has been a short note twice (2018, 2026).

Blind spots and likely next questions

- **Brexit's causes and consequences** (not asked since 2017, and now a finished story).
- **Devolution and the Union** — the Scottish referendum of 2014, Northern Ireland after Brexit.
- **Brown's premiership** as a whole.

- **The post-2016 governments** — May, Johnson, Truss, Sunak, Starmer — and **the monarchy** (Elizabeth II's reign, Charles III).

The core in one page

- **People:** Tony Blair · Gordon Brown · Alastair Campbell · George W. Bush · Saddam Hussein · David Cameron · Nick Clegg · George Osborne · Theresa May · Boris Johnson · Liz Truss · Rishi Sunak · Keir Starmer · Diana · Charles III.
- **Dates:** Blair's landslide **1 May 1997** · Diana dies **31 August 1997** · Good Friday Agreement **10 April 1998** · devolved parliaments **1999** · 9/11 **2001** · Iraq invaded **20 March 2003** · 7/7 **2005** · Northern Rock **2007** · Lehman collapse **15 September 2008** · coalition **May 2010** · Scottish referendum **18 September 2014** · EU referendum **23 June 2016** · Brexit **31 January 2020** · Elizabeth II dies **8 September 2022** · Starmer's landslide **4 July 2024**.
- **Terms:** **New Labour** · **Third Way** · **devolution** · **liberal interventionism** · **War on Terror** · **Chilcot Report** · **credit crunch** · **quantitative easing** · **austerity** · **Big Society** · **Brexit** · **Article 50**.

What the T10 documents will carry

Maps: **Iraq and Afghanistan** (Basra, Helmand); **the 2016 referendum result** by nation and region; **devolved Britain**. Figures: the 2008 crisis as a chain from sub-prime to austerity; New Labour against Old Labour and Thatcherism (a three-column comparison); Prime Ministers 1997–2026 time-line; election results 1997–2024.

VERDICT · Priority

Tier 1. Weight **11%**; **8 MCQs**. The most current topic and, since 2021, the most frequently asked.

Part Five — How a British History Answer Scores

5.1 What the examiner is actually marking

A British History examiner reads hundreds of scripts that tell the same story. What separates the marks is not how much history a candidate knows but **what the candidate does with it**. Five things are rewarded, in roughly this order:

1. **Relevance** — every paragraph answers the question that was set, in its own words.
2. **Argument** — a clear thesis in the introduction, carried through the answer, ending in a verdict.
3. **Evidence** — dates, names, laws, numbers, places; accurate and specific.
4. **Balance** — the other side of the case, and the historians who argue it.
5. **Structure and presentation** — headings, a map or diagram, a table where it helps, clean paragraphs.

Band	Typical marks out of 20	What the script looks like
Top	15–17	Answers every limb; clear thesis and verdict; dense, accurate evidence; a counter-view with a historian; a relevant map or figure; headings that echo the question
Good	12–14	Relevant and accurate; some argument; evidence present but thinner; balance weak or verdict vague
Middle	9–11	Mostly narrative; some relevance; few dates; no real argument; one limb of the question neglected
Weak	below 9	A prepared essay on a neighbouring subject; errors of fact; no structure

NOTE · Honest expectations

CSS optional papers are marked strictly. A score of **60–70 out of 100** in British History is a strong result. The model answers in this set aim at the top band — but a disciplined middle-to-good answer on **all four** questions beats two brilliant answers and two weak ones.

5.2 The eight moves

THE EIGHT MOVES OF A BRITISH HISTORY ANSWER

The same spine for every 20-mark question; short notes use moves 2, 5 and 8

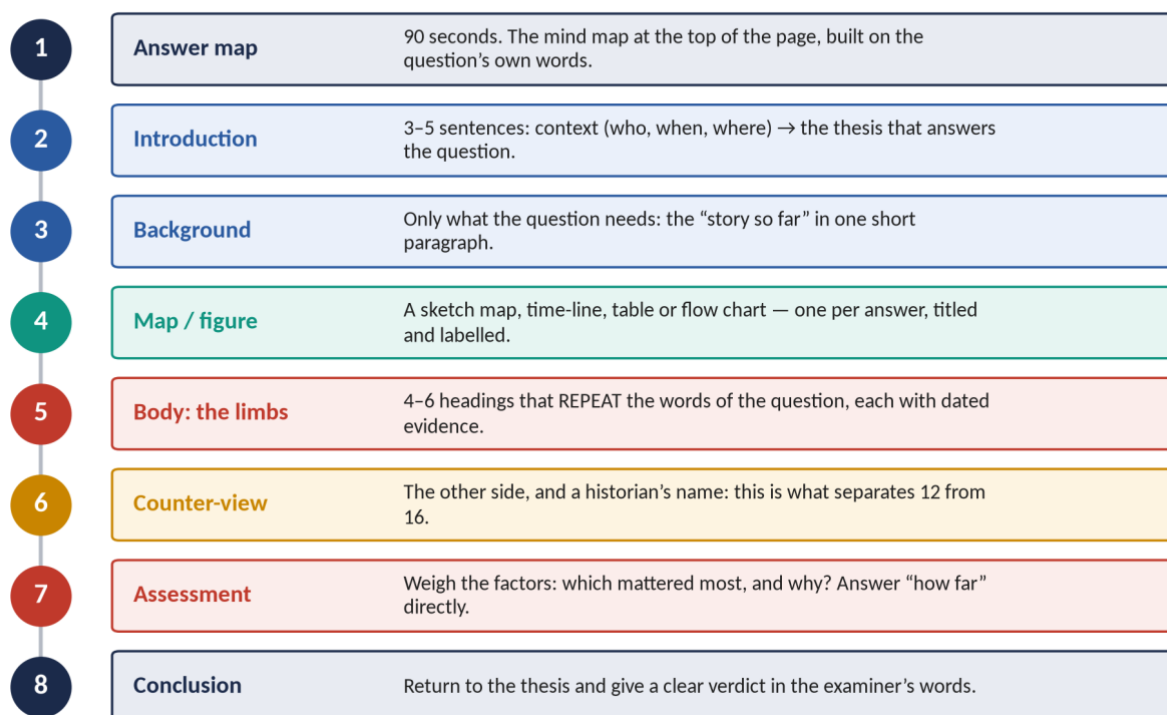


Figure 12 • The eight moves of a British History answer. Every model answer in the QA documents follows this spine.

Move 1 — the answer map (90 seconds)

At the top of the first page, draw the **answer map**: the question's key words in the centre, one branch for each heading you will write, two or three evidence points on each branch, and a one-line verdict. It forces you to plan, it shows the examiner your structure before he reads a word, and it protects the fourth answer from running out of time. Part 5.3 shows how to build one.

Move 2 — the introduction (3–5 sentences)

Set the scene (who, when, where) in one sentence, define any key term the question uses, and state your **thesis** — your answer to the question — in one sentence. Do not tell the story in the introduction.

Move 3 — the background (one short paragraph)

Only the background the question needs. For a question on the Reform Act of 1832, that is the unreformed system in five lines — not the history of Parliament since 1688.

Move 4 — the map or figure

One per answer. A **sketch map** for anything that happened somewhere (a war, a partition, an empire); a **time-line** for anything that unfolded over years; a **table** for any comparison; a **flow chart** for causes and consequences. Title it, label it, and refer to it in the text.

Move 5 — the body: the limbs of the question

Four to six headings. **Each heading repeats words from the question** (Part 5.5). Under each: a topic sentence that makes a point, then dated evidence, then a sentence that links back to the question.

Move 6 — the counter-view

The other side of the case, with a named historian where possible. This is what separates 12 from 16.

Move 7 — the assessment

Weigh the factors. Which mattered most, and why? If the question says "how far", answer it: *largely, to a considerable extent, only partly, hardly at all.*

Move 8 — the conclusion

Return to the thesis. Give the verdict in the examiner's own words. Two or three sentences; no new evidence.

5.3 The answer map — the house rule

The answer map is a mind map built **from the words of the question**. It is not a general diagram of the topic. Every branch must be traceable to a word or phrase in the question, so that anyone reading the map — even someone who knows no British history — can see exactly how the answer is organised and why.

ANSWER MAP • CSS 2019 • Q2 • SECTION A

What was so glorious about the Glorious Revolution? Discuss its significance in British history.

KEY WORDS “so glorious” • “significance” • “in British history”

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Explain the label: WHY contemporaries and historians called it “glorious” — and test it. (2) Its SIGNIFICANCE: what changed for good afterwards. End with a verdict.

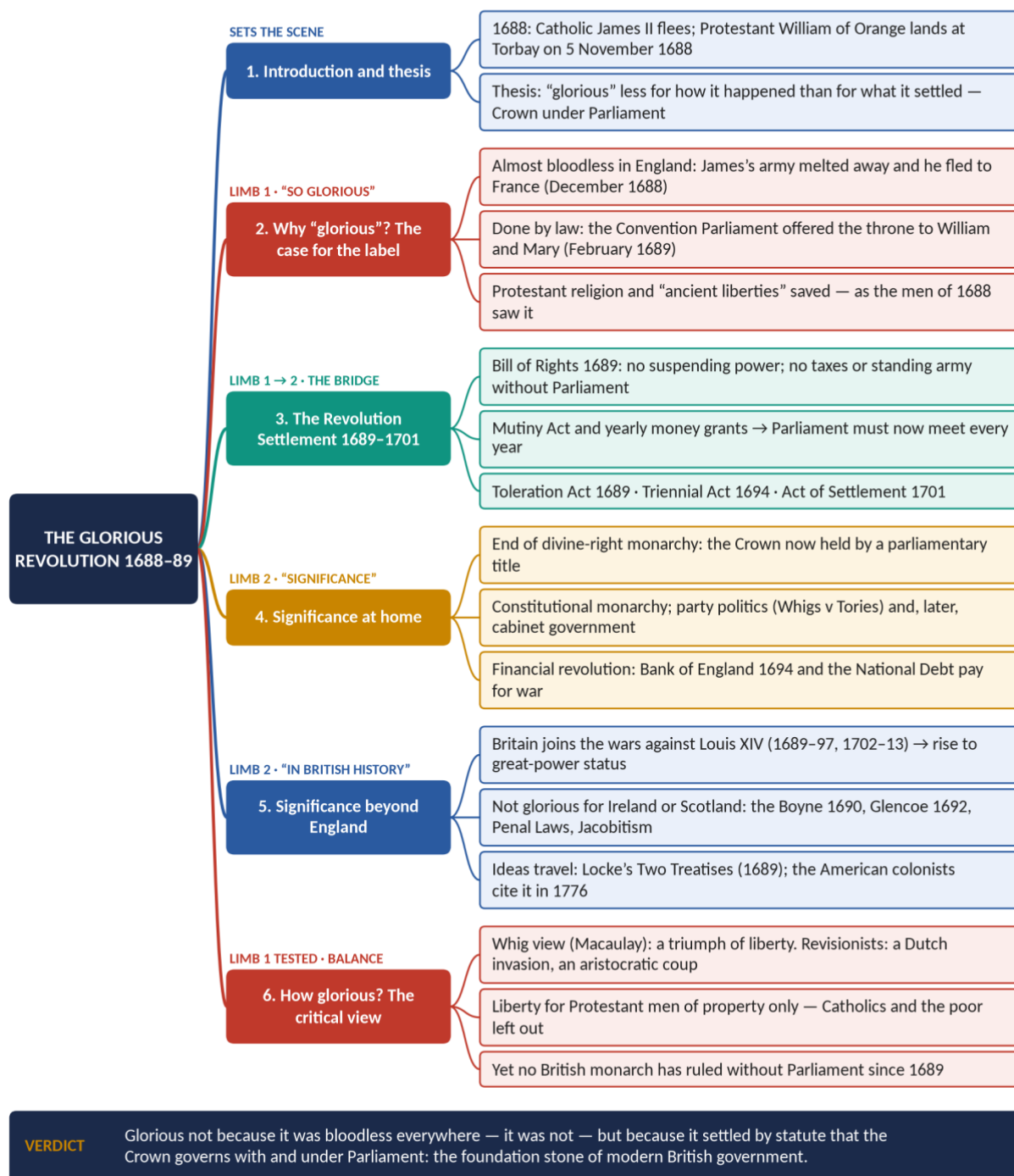


Figure 13 • A model answer map for CSS 2019 Q2. The coloured tags above each branch show which part of the question that branch answers.

How to build it — five steps

- Underline the key words.** In "*What was so glorious about the Glorious Revolution? Discuss its significance in British history*" they are **so glorious**, **significance** and **in British history**.
- Count the limbs.** Here there are two: explain and test the label "glorious"; then assess the significance.
- Turn each limb into branches.** Limb 1 becomes "why glorious — the case for" and "how glorious — the critical view"; limb 2 becomes "significance at home" and "significance beyond England". Add the introduction and a bridge branch (the settlement).
- Hang two or three pieces of evidence on each branch** — each with a date or a name.
- Write the verdict** in one line at the bottom, in the question's words.

THE RULE · Every answer map in this set follows six rules

One: the question is printed at the top, with its key words picked out. **Two:** a line says what the question demands. **Three:** every branch is numbered and matches a heading in the answer. **Four:** every branch is tagged with the limb of the question it answers. **Five:** every leaf is a full phrase with a date or name — no single words. **Six:** a verdict closes the map.

5.4 The introduction that earns marks

A good introduction does three jobs in about 80–100 words: **context**, **definition**, **thesis**.

THE EVIDENCE · Model introduction · CSS 2019 Q5 · "The Reform Act of 1832 made possible the series of political and administrative reforms that laid the foundation of modern Britain. Discuss."

Context: In 1832 the Whig government of Earl Grey, after a year of crisis and riots, carried the first Reform Act through a reluctant House of Lords. *Definition:* The Act abolished 56 rotten boroughs, gave seats to the new industrial towns and extended the vote to middle-class householders. *Thesis:* It did not create democracy — about four adult men in five still could not vote — but it broke the principle that the constitution could not be changed, and so made possible the reforming decade that followed and the Reform Acts of 1867, 1884 and 1918: in that sense it did lay the foundation of modern Britain.

5.5 Headings that repeat the question

The headings are the argument. An examiner skimming your headings should be able to see that you answered the question.

The question's words	Headings that echo them
"What were the merits and demerits of Whig rule? What led to the downfall of Whig ascendancy?" (2017)	(1) The Whig ascendancy, 1714–1760 · (2) The merits of Whig rule: stability, peace, prosperity · (3) The demerits : corruption, oligarchy, neglect · (4) What led to the downfall : George III, Bute, the King's Friends · (5) The downfall assessed · (6) Conclusion

The question's words	Headings that echo them
"How far was the decline of the British Empire after 1945 the result of global pressures rather than internal political decisions?" (2026)	(1) The decline of empire, 1945–1980 · (2) Global pressures: the superpowers, the UN, nationalism, war debts · (3) Internal political decisions: Attlee, Macmillan, the end of national service, East of Suez · (4) Case one — India 1947 · (5) Case two — Suez 1956 · (6) Case three — Kenya and Africa 1960–63 · (7) How far? Weighing the two · (8) Conclusion

5.6 Evidence — and the historians worth quoting

Evidence is specific: a date, a law, a number, a name, a place. "The Reform Act gave more people the vote" is a claim; "the Reform Act raised the electorate of England and Wales from roughly 400,000 to about 650,000" is evidence.

Historians turn a narrative into an argument. You do not need many — one name and one idea per answer is enough — but they must be accurate. These are the ones that serve the most questions.

Historian	Topic	The idea to quote
Thomas Babington Macaulay , <i>History of England</i> (1848–61)	T1	The Whig view: 1688 was the triumph of liberty that saved England from revolution.
G. M. Trevelyan , <i>The English Revolution 1688–1689</i> (1938)	T1	The Revolution was "glorious" because it was bloodless and conservative.
J. H. Plumb , <i>The Growth of Political Stability in England 1675–1725</i> (1967)	T1, T2	Stability after 1688 was made by Walpole's system of patronage and one-party rule.
Lewis Namier , <i>The Structure of Politics at the Accession of George III</i> (1929)	T2	Eighteenth-century politics was about interest and patronage, not parties or principle.
Linda Colley , <i>Britons: Forging the Nation 1707–1837</i> (1992)	T1–T3	Protestantism, war with France and empire forged a British identity.
Eric Williams , <i>Capitalism and Slavery</i> (1944)	T2, T4	Abolition came because slavery had become less profitable, not only from humanitarian motives.
Seymour Drescher , <i>Econocide</i> (1977)	T2, T4	Against Williams: Britain abolished the slave trade when it was still profitable — a moral and political choice.
Edmund Burke and Thomas Paine (1790–92)	T3	The two poles of the British debate on the French Revolution.
Élie Halévy (from 1913)	T3, T4	Methodism channelled discontent into religion and helped Britain avoid revolution.
E. P. Thompson , <i>The Making of the English Working Class</i> (1963)	T3, T4	The working class "made itself" in 1790–1830; Methodism was partly a "chiliasm of despair".
Eric Hobsbawm , <i>The Age of Revolution</i> (1962)	T3, T4	The "dual revolution" — French political and British industrial.

Historian	Topic	The idea to quote
T. S. Ashton , <i>The Industrial Revolution 1760–1830</i> (1948)	T4	The optimistic view: industrialisation raised living standards.
N. F. R. Crafts (1985)	T4	Growth was slower and more gradual than "revolution" suggests.
Norman Gash , <i>Sir Robert Peel</i> (1972)	T5	Peel as the founder of modern Conservatism who put nation before party.
Robert Blake , <i>Disraeli</i> (1966)	T5, T6	Disraeli the opportunist genius who made the Conservatives a national party.
Robinson and Gallagher , "The Imperialism of Free Trade" (1953)	T6	Britain preferred informal empire through trade; formal rule only when necessary.
George Dangerfield , <i>The Strange Death of Liberal England</i> (1935)	T7	The Liberal Party was already dying before 1914.
Trevor Wilson , <i>The Downfall of the Liberal Party 1914–1935</i> (1966)	T7	The war, like a "rampant omnibus", ran the Liberals down.
A. J. P. Taylor , <i>The Origins of the Second World War</i> (1961)	T7, T8	Hitler was an opportunist; appeasement was a rational policy that failed.
Correlli Barnett , <i>The Audit of War</i> (1986)	T8	Attlee's "New Jerusalem" welfare state was bought at the cost of modernising industry.
Peter Hennessy , <i>Never Again: Britain 1945–51</i> (1992)	T8	The Attlee years as the foundation of post-war Britain.
John Darwin , <i>Britain and Decolonisation</i> (1988)	T8	Empire ended through international, British and colonial pressures together.
Dean Acheson (1962)	T8	"Great Britain has lost an empire and has not yet found a role."
Stuart Hall (1979) and Andrew Gamble , <i>The Free Economy and the Strong State</i> (1988)	T9	Thatcherism combined a free market with a strong, authoritarian state.
Hugo Young , <i>This Blessed Plot</i> (1998)	T8–T10	Britain's half-hearted relationship with Europe since 1945.
Anthony Giddens , <i>The Third Way</i> (1998)	T10	The intellectual basis of New Labour.
The Chilcot Report (2016)	T10	The UK went to war in Iraq before peaceful options were exhausted.

5.7 Maps and diagrams in a history answer

A map earns marks when it shows something the words cannot show as quickly — where the fighting was, what was gained, how a border moved. Draw it in **three minutes** with a pencil: outline, three to six labelled places, arrows for movement, shading for gains, a title and a key.

The twelve master maps to practise

#	Map	Answers questions on
1	The British Isles 1688–1746 (Torbay, the Boyne, Glencoe, Culloden)	The Glorious Revolution, the Union of 1707, the Jacobites (T1, T2)
2	Europe in the wars against Louis XIV (Blenheim, Utrecht gains)	Augsburg, Ryswick, the Spanish Succession (T1)
3	The world in 1763 and the Thirteen Colonies	The Seven Years' War, Chatham, the American war (T2)
4	Napoleonic Europe (Trafalgar, the Peninsula, Waterloo)	The French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars (T3)
5	Industrial Britain c.1850	The Industrial Revolution, Chartism (T4)
6	Ireland 1798–1922	The Union of 1801, the Famine, Home Rule, partition (T3, T5)
7	The Ottoman Empire, the Straits and the Balkans in 1878	The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin (T6)
8	Europe's alliances 1902–1914	Splendid Isolation and its end; the causes of WWI (T6, T7)
9	Hitler's expansion 1936–1939	Appeasement, the causes of WWII (T7, T8)
10	The partition of India 1947	Decolonisation (T8)
11	Decolonisation by date (Asia, Middle East, Africa)	The end of empire, the Commonwealth, Suez (T8)
12	The Falkland Islands and the South Atlantic 1982	The Falklands War (T9)

Each map is drawn in full, with the three-minute sketch version, in the topic documents.

5.8 The counter-view and the verdict

The newest papers ask for judgement (Part 3.9). A judgement needs a method:

- 1. Name the factors.** For "how far was X the result of Y?", Y is one factor; list the others.
- 2. Give each a fair case.** Evidence for its importance, and its limits.
- 3. Rank them.** Which was necessary? Which was sufficient? Which was the trigger, and which the underlying cause?
- 4. State the verdict in the question's words** — "largely", "to a limited extent" — and give the single strongest reason.

VERDICT • A verdict is a sentence, not a shrug

Weak: "There were many factors, and all played their part." Strong: "Global pressures made the end of empire inevitable, but British decisions — above all Attlee's in 1947 and Macmillan's after 1959 — decided that it would come quickly and, outside Kenya and Aden, largely peacefully."

5.9 Short notes — ten marks each

A short note is not a short essay. It is a **precise, dense summary** in about 450–600 words, written in 17 minutes. Use five parts:

1. **Definition or identification** (1–2 sentences): who or what, when, where.
2. **Background** (2–3 sentences): why it came about.
3. **Main features or events** (the core, with dates): 4–6 points under a small heading or bold phrases.
4. **Significance** (3–4 sentences): what it changed, and why the examiner cares.
5. **One-line assessment**, with a historian or a quotation if you have one.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · The short notes set in 2015–2026

Industrial Revolution · Methodist Movement (twice) · Jacobite Revolt · Second World War · Treaty of Berlin · Fabianism · Sir Winston Churchill · Britain's role in the EU · Lady Diana (twice) · Lord Kitchener · Suez Canal Crisis · Utilitarianism · Falkland War · Reforms under David Cameron (twice) · Creation of the Commonwealth · Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society · Britain's role in the War on Terror · John Major's foreign policy. Every one is answered in the QA documents.

5.10 Ten mistakes that cost marks

#	The mistake	The cure
1	Writing the prepared answer to a different question	Build the answer map from the question's own words, every time.
2	Ignoring the second limb of a two-part question	Count the limbs before writing; give each its own heading.
3	Telling the story without an argument	State a thesis in the introduction; end with a verdict.
4	No dates	Put a date in almost every evidence sentence.
5	Wrong country name for the period	England before 1707; Great Britain 1707–1800; the UK from 1801.
6	One-sided answers	Always a counter-view, with a historian where possible.
7	A vague "how far"	Answer it in words of degree: largely, partly, hardly.
8	Ignoring the requirement the question names	"Use regional examples" or "three cases" means exactly that.
9	A brilliant first answer and a starved fourth	Watch the clock: 35 minutes each.
10	Unlabelled or irrelevant maps	Title, labels, key — and refer to it in the text.

5.11 The objective part in thirty minutes

- **Do the paper in one pass**, answering everything you know at once; mark the rest.

- **Return to the marked items** with the remaining time. Eliminate options you *know* are wrong.
- **If all three printed options are wrong, choose D "None of these"**. In 2024–2026 it was correct in 12 of 60 items.
- **Exact dates matter.** Several items test the day and month (28 June 1919; 2 June 1953; 18 June 1815; 11 December 1936). The One-Liner Bank in this set drills these.

Part Six — The Plan

6.1 A sixteen-week plan

A SIXTEEN-WEEK PLAN

Heavy topics get a week and a half; the MCQ bank runs alongside every week

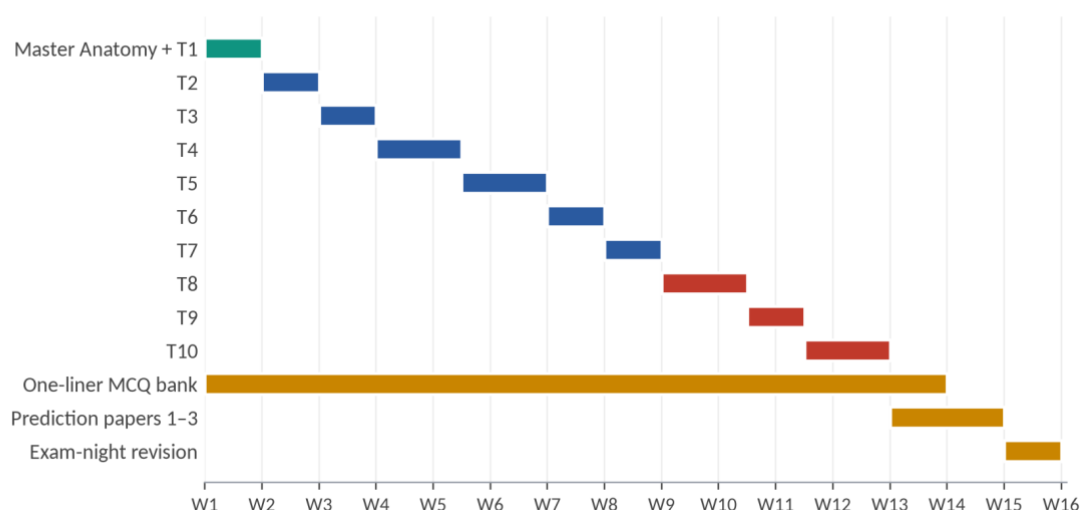


Figure 14 • Sixteen weeks from the first page to the exam. The heaviest topics (T4, T5, T8, T10) get a week and a half each.

Weeks	Topic	What to do
1	Master Anatomy + T1	Read Part Zero twice. Then T1KB; then T1QA. Draw the British Isles map from memory.
2	T2	T2KB, T2QA. Practise the Walpole answer under time (35 minutes).
3	T3	T3KB, T3QA. Learn the French-Revolution-in-Britain answer until you can plan it in 90 seconds.
4–5	T4	T4KB, T4QA. Three families: Industrial Revolution, Methodism, Chartism. Write one timed answer on each.
5–6	T5	T5KB, T5QA. Build the one-page reform time-line 1832–1928. Peel three ways.
7	T6	T6KB, T6QA. Splendid Isolation first; then Palmerston, the Eastern Question and Berlin.
8	T7	T7KB, T7QA. WWI and Labour; then the blind spots — Versailles and appeasement.
9–10	T8	T8KB, T8QA. Decolonisation with three cases; the Commonwealth; Churchill; Attlee.
10–11	T9	T9KB, T9QA. The Falklands map; Thatcherism defined; Europe to Maastricht.
11–12	T10	T10KB, T10QA. New Labour, the War on Terror, 2008, Cameron's reforms, Brexit, to 2026.

Weeks	Topic	What to do
1–14	One-Liner Bank	Twenty to thirty one-liners every day, from each topic as you finish it; the combined bank after week 12.
13–14	Prediction papers	Sit Set 1 open-book, Set 2 closed-book untimed, Set 3 under exam conditions.
15	Exam-night revision	The combined revision sheets; the Tier 1 families; the twelve master maps.
16	Buffer	Illness, other papers, rest — or a second pass of Tier 1.

KEY IDEA · The one rule of the plan

Finish every topic's QA document before starting the next topic. Reading a Knowledge Base feels like progress; answering questions *is* progress. Each week should end with at least one answer written by hand under a 35-minute clock.

6.2 How to use each document

The Knowledge Base, in three readings

- 1. First reading — the story.** Read the story section and the story boxes only. Look at every map. Do not take notes.
- 2. Second reading — the structure.** Read everything. Fill in the blank time-line at the back from memory. Learn the key terms (crimson) and the dates (teal).
- 3. Third reading — the revision sheet.** Read only the revision sheet, and test yourself with the topic's one-liners.

The Question Answers, in three passes

- 1. Read** every answer with its answer map.
- 2. Re-draw** the answer map for each question from memory, then check it.
- 3. Write** at least two answers per topic by hand under the clock — then compare with the model.

6.3 The last fortnight

- Re-read **Part Three** of this document (the record and the tiers) and decide your **Section B plan**: which two of T8, T9, T10 families you will be strongest in, and which third you will be ready to fall back on.
- Re-draw **the twelve master maps** (Part 5.7) — one a day.
- Re-plan every **Tier 1** family: 90 seconds each, from memory.
- Sit the **three prediction papers** under exam conditions.
- Drill the **One-Liner Bank** daily — especially exact dates.

6.4 The day of the paper

1. In the thirty-minute objective part, answer everything, then return to the marked items. Trust D when the options are all wrong.
2. In the first five minutes of Part II, **read all seven questions**. Tick the two you will answer in each section. For Section B, decide in the first minute.
3. Draw each **answer map** before writing that answer.
4. Keep to **35 minutes per answer**. Check the clock at 1:05, 1:40, 2:15 and 2:50.
5. Spend the last five minutes checking that every heading echoes the question and every answer has a verdict.

6.5 After the ten topics

When all ten topics are finished, four combined documents will be built from them:

- **The One-Liner Bank (OL)** — all the topics' one-liner MCQs in one place, by topic.
- **The QA print volume** — only the questions and answers of all ten QA documents, in one Word file, with nothing else, for printing.
- **The Exam-Night Revision (RN)** — all ten revision sheets, each complete on its own.
- **The Prediction Papers (PR)** — three complete papers modelled on the record, each with full answer plans.

Appendix A — Every Descriptive Question, 2015–2026, by Year

The complete descriptive record as set, with each item's topic and family. "A" and "B" are the sections; in 2015, "P1" and "P2" are the two papers of the former scheme. Short-note options are marked.

2015 — the former two-paper scheme

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
P1 · Q2	What forced James II to issue the various Declarations of Indulgence?	T1 · The Glorious Revolution
P1 · Q3	Account for the War of the League of Augsburg followed by the Treaty of Ryswick.	T1 · William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession)
P1 · Q4	Evaluate analytically and critically the role of Walpole as Secretary of State, Prime Minister, party organiser and financier.	T2 · Walpole and the Whig oligarchy
P1 · Q5	Shed light on the American War of Independence with special reference to its debit side and credit side for Great Britain.	T2 · American War of Independence
P1 · Q6	The short reign of William IV is considered to be the long era of bills and acts. Substantiate the statement with supportive arguments.	T5 · Parliamentary reform 1832–1928
P1 · Q7	'Palmerston was at once a Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither a Whig nor a Tory.' Elucidate.	T6 · Palmerston
P1 · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Industrial Revolution	T4 · The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution
P1 · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Methodist Movement	T4 · The Methodist Movement
P1 · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Jacobite Revolt of Scotland	T2 · The Jacobite risings
P2 · Q2	Palmerston was conservative at home and liberal abroad. Discuss and conclude with arguments.	T6 · Palmerston
P2 · Q3	Describe the emergence of the Methodist Movement in England. What were its good and bad effects on the people?	T4 · The Methodist Movement
P2 · Q4	Analyze the characters and policies of Gladstone and Disraeli with special reference to foreign affairs.	T6 · Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad
P2 · Q5	What was the background in the context of which the Crimean War broke out? Discuss and analyze the results that followed the cessation of hostilities.	T6 · The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin
P2 · Q6	How has the idea of the British Commonwealth of Nations developed? In what ways does its significance differ from the term British Empire?	T8 · The Commonwealth
P2 · Q7	Why did Britain adopt the Policy of Splendid Isolation from 1870 onwards in external affairs? How was this policy abandoned by the end of the 19th century? Discuss and analyze.	T6 · Splendid Isolation and its end

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
P2 · Q8	Describe and critically analyze the foreign policy of England from 1919 to 1939.	T7 · Inter-war foreign policy and the League

2016

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What measures were adopted by England to check the influence of the French Revolution of 1789 on England?	T3 · The French Revolution and Britain
A · Q3	Analyze critically the Reform Act of 1832.	T5 · Parliamentary reform 1832–1928
A · Q4	'Lord Palmerston was more successful as Foreign Minister than as Prime Minister.' Critically analyze.	T6 · Palmerston
A · Q5	Explain the policy of Disraeli with special reference to 'Peace with Honour'.	T6 · Gladstone vs Disraeli; Disraeli abroad
B · Q6	'Margaret Thatcher is judged to be the best post-war Prime Minister of England.' Discuss.	T9 · Thatcher and Thatcherism
B · Q7	Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron with special reference to the Middle East.	T10 · David Cameron
B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Second World War	T8 · The Second World War and Churchill
B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Treaty of Berlin	T6 · The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin
B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Fabianism	T4 · Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism

2017

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What were the merits and demerits of Whig rule? What led to the downfall of Whig ascendancy? Analyze comprehensively.	T2 · Walpole and the Whig oligarchy
A · Q3	The Industrial Revolution drastically changed methods of production in England. How did it affect the social, economic, political and cultural life of the English people?	T4 · The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution
A · Q4	Give a comprehensive account of the Chartist Movement. Why did it fail? Explain and analyse.	T4 · Chartism
A · Q5	'Gladstone's domestic policy was the climax of liberalism.' Discuss comprehensively.	T5 · Gladstone's domestic policy
B · Q6	Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.	T6 · The Eastern Question, Crimea, Berlin
B · Q7	What do you understand by the British Commonwealth of Nations and how did it develop? How does it differ from the term British Empire?	T8 · The Commonwealth

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
B · Q8	What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments.	T10 · Brexit

2018

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What led to the occurrence of the ultra-degree of mega development towards the close of the 17th century in Britain known as the 'Glorious Revolution'?	T1 · The Glorious Revolution
A · Q3	'The 18th century witnessed the emergence, rise and growth of two movements (Agrarian and Industrial) which revolutionised the lives of the English people in particular and later the world in general.' Comment on the statement.	T4 · The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution
A · Q4	Shed ample light on the interior as well as exterior policy of Sir Robert Peel as British Premier, with particular emphasis on the Irish issue.	T5 · Sir Robert Peel
A · Q5	What measures were taken for the democratisation of the British Parliament over the decades?	T5 · Parliamentary reform 1832–1928
B · Q6	How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What were its positive and negative aspects?	T6 · Splendid Isolation and its end
B · Q7	Why is it believed in certain circles that after decolonisation Britain was subservient to the US line of action during the Cold War and thereafter, down to 9/11 and subsequent years? Do you agree or not? Argue.	T8 · The special relationship with the USA
B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Sir Winston Churchill	T8 · The Second World War and Churchill
B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Britain's role in the EU	T9 · Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)
B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana	T10 · Diana, Princess of Wales

2019

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What was so glorious about the Glorious Revolution? Discuss its significance in British history.	T1 · The Glorious Revolution
A · Q3	What was the political and constitutional significance of the Hanoverian succession in England?	T2 · The Hanoverian succession
A · Q4	Explain the factors that led to the Industrial Revolution and discuss how it affected the social, political, economic and cultural life of the English people.	T4 · The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution
A · Q5	The Reform Act of 1832 made possible the series of political and administrative reforms that laid the foundation of modern Britain. Discuss.	T5 · Parliamentary reform 1832–1928
B · Q6	How successfully did the Labour government of 1945–51 tackle the economic and social problems of post-World War II Britain?	T8 · Attlee's Labour government 1945–51

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
B · Q7	What were the motives behind Britain's move to decolonisation after 1945? Also explain why and how the British left India in 1947.	T8 · Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez
B · Q8	Explain why John Major and the Conservatives won the general election of 1992 but lost the election of 1997.	T9 · John Major

2020

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What are the merits and demerits of the Whig oligarchy? Critically examine the causes of the downfall of Whig ascendancy.	T2 · Walpole and the Whig oligarchy
A · Q3	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	T3 · The French Revolution and Britain
A · Q4	Give a history of parliamentary reforms between 1832 and 1928. Also critically examine how England became a politically democratic country.	T5 · Parliamentary reform 1832–1928
A · Q5	'Peel was the most liberal of conservatives and the most conservative of liberals.' Examine the statement critically.	T5 · Sir Robert Peel
B · Q6	What do you know about the Middle East and Suez Canal Crisis? Also explain why England withdrew from Palestine and the Suez Canal. Discuss.	T8 · Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez
B · Q7	What do you know about the League of Nations? Explain the work of the League. What were the causes of its failure?	T7 · Inter-war foreign policy and the League
B · Q8	What were the causes of the Falkland War? In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?	T9 · The Falklands War

2021

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	What were the political and ideological differences among Non-Jurors, High Churchmen and Latitudinarians?	T1 · Church parties after 1688 (Non-Jurors, High Church, Latitudinarians)
A · Q3	What were the political and constitutional causes and consequences of the Act of Union 1707?	T1 · Union of England and Scotland, 1707
A · Q4	Provide a detailed account of the causes of World War I and its effects on the social and economic aspects of Britain.	T7 · The First World War and its effects
A · Q5	What is the Edwardian era? Elucidate the rise and significance of the Labour Movement in the Edwardian era.	T7 · Edwardian era and the rise of Labour
B · Q6	What was the Falkland Islands conflict? Why did the British invade the Falkland Islands and how did this war come to an end?	T9 · The Falklands War
B · Q7	What was the contribution of Great Britain to the formation of the European Common Market and the European Union? Also highlight its impact on the foreign policy of Britain.	T9 · Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)
B · Q8	What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror? How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?	T10 · The War on Terror

2022

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	The domestic policy of Gladstone was the climax of liberalism during the 19th century. Discuss and analyze.	T5 · Gladstone's domestic policy
A · Q3	'A glorious success until 1761 and then failure.' Do you agree with this estimate of the career of Chatham?	T2 · Pitt the Elder (Chatham)
A · Q4	Discuss the rise of the Labour Party in Britain and enumerate the achievements of this party.	T7 · Edwardian era and the rise of Labour
A · Q5	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	T3 · The French Revolution and Britain
B · Q6	Explain the genesis of the Falkland War. How has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?	T9 · The Falklands War
B · Q7	Discuss Winston Churchill as a statesman, warrior and a man of letters.	T8 · The Second World War and Churchill
B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Lord Kitchener	T7 · The First World War and its effects
B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Suez Canal Crisis	T8 · Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez
B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Utilitarianism	T4 · Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism

2023

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	How did the Glorious Revolution occur in Britain? What was its fallout at home and abroad?	T1 · The Glorious Revolution
A · Q3	'The English people got so much frightened by the developments in France that there prevailed a sort of panic across the country.' Analyse the after-effects of the French Revolution on England.	T3 · The French Revolution and Britain
A · Q4	Why did Britain initiate the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What is your personal opinion whether it was a right step in the right direction or proved detrimental?	T6 · Splendid Isolation and its end
A · Q5	According to Rudyard Kipling, 'however the world pretends to divide itself, there are only two divisions in the world today — human beings and Germans.' In the light of this statement, was British policy in the First World War justified or not? Comment.	T7 · The First World War and its effects
B · Q6	Produce an analytical essay on the causes, major developments and aftermath of the Second World War.	T8 · The Second World War and Churchill
B · Q7	'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.	T10 · The War on Terror
B · Q8	How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession in the 21st century and how did it respond?	T10 · The 2008 financial crisis

2024

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q1	How far did Robert Peel's methods of governance differ from those of his predecessors, viz. Liverpool, Canning and Wellington?	T5 · Sir Robert Peel
A · Q2	Define the 'Irish Question'. Also discuss the policy of the Liberal Party on the said issue from 1886 to 1894.	T5 · The Irish Question and Home Rule
A · Q3	Describe the reasons due to which millions of people united in support of the Chartist Movement in the mid-19th century to attain democratic rights for the working classes.	T4 · Chartism
A · Q4	How did the Methodist Movement begin? Also explain its salient features and reasons for success.	T4 · The Methodist Movement
B · Q5	Define the term 'Thatcherism'. Discuss Margaret Thatcher's economic and educational reforms and their impacts on people's lives.	T9 · Thatcher and Thatcherism
B · Q6	How did World War II and the Cold War trigger the decolonization of the British Empire?	T8 · Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez
B · Q7(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Falkland War	T9 · The Falklands War
B · Q7(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under David Cameron	T10 · David Cameron
B · Q7(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Creation of the Commonwealth	T8 · The Commonwealth

2025

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	Discuss the significance of Queen Anne's reign in shaping the course of the War of Spanish Succession and its impact on the balance of power in Europe.	T1 · William's and Anne's wars (Augsburg, Spanish Succession)
A · Q3	Analyze the controversies surrounding the Act of Union 1801, focusing on the differing perspectives of Irish and British politicians. Assess its impact on Irish nationalism and the stability of the United Kingdom.	T3 · Union with Ireland, 1801
A · Q4	Examine the evolution of party politics in Britain during the 19th century, focusing on the rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties, and the changing relationship between government, parliament and the electorate.	T5 · Rise of the Conservative and Liberal parties
A · Q5	Compare and contrast the ideologies of Socialism and Liberalism in Britain during the 19th century, examining their differing approaches to issues such as economic inequality, social justice and the role of the state.	T4 · Ideas: Liberalism, Socialism, Utilitarianism, Fabianism
B · Q6	How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments? Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?	T10 · Blair and New Labour
B · Q7	How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society? How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ, and what were their long-term effects?	T10 · The 2008 financial crisis
B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society	T3 · The French Revolution and Britain

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Methodist Movement	T4 · The Methodist Movement
B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> Reforms under Cameron Government	T10 · David Cameron

2026

Q	The question as set	Topic · family
A · Q2	Examine the complex relationships between abolition, imperialism, and economic interests, and argue for or against the notion that Britain's anti-slavery movement was a thinly veiled justification for colonial expansion.	T2 · Slavery, abolition and empire
A · Q3	Critically evaluate the extent to which the Industrial Revolution transformed British society more through disruption than through progress. Use regional examples to support your argument.	T4 · The Industrial (and Agricultural) Revolution
A · Q4	How far was the decline of the British Empire after 1945 the result of global pressures rather than internal political decisions? Support your analysis with at least three major real end-of-decolonisation cases.	T8 · Decolonisation, India, Palestine, Suez
A · Q5	Critically evaluate the effects of World War I on British social structure, industrial relations, and the polity, highlighting the ways in which the war accelerated the decline of the Liberal Party and paved the way for Labour's rise to power.	T7 · The First World War and its effects
B · Q6	Discuss the impact of European integration on British politics and identity since 1973, with particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro.	T9 · Britain and Europe (EEC/EU)
B · Q7	From 1997 to 2012, Britain saw dramatic shifts in foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity. Assess whether the period should be interpreted as one of renewal or of unresolved contradictions in British governance.	T10 · Blair and New Labour
B · Q8(a)	<i>Short note:</i> Britain's role in the War on Terror	T10 · The War on Terror
B · Q8(b)	<i>Short note:</i> Lady Diana Spencer	T10 · Diana, Princess of Wales
B · Q8(c)	<i>Short note:</i> John Major's foreign policy	T9 · John Major

Appendix B — The Objective Papers, 2024–2026

All sixty recoverable MCQs, with their keyed answers and topics. Where the printed options did not contain the correct answer, the key is "None of these" with the fact supplied.

2024 objective paper

#	Stem	Keyed answer	Topic
1	Who is the longest-serving British Prime Minister?	A. Robert Walpole	T2
2	The British colony of Singapore was established as a trading post along which important maritime route?	B. Strait of Malacca	T6
3	The “Scramble for Africa” refers to the period of intense European colonial expansion in Africa during which centuries?	C. 19th and 20th centuries	T6
4	What is the highest rank in the British nobility?	B. Duke	G
5	The Treaty of Versailles was signed on:	C. 28 June 1919	T7
6	How many British Prime Ministers served during World War I?	A. Two — H. H. Asquith and David Lloyd George	T7
7	Which adjective is commonly associated with London in the 1960s?	C. Swinging	T8
8	The Act of Union between England and Scotland took effect in:	B. 1707	T1
9	Who succeeded Margaret Thatcher as Prime Minister?	D. None of these — John Major	T9
10	Which Prime Minister sent British troops to Iraq in 2003?	B. Tony Blair	T10
11	The Bank of England was nationalised in:	B. 1946	T8
12	Queen Elizabeth II was crowned on:	A. 2 June 1953	T8
13	Who was the British monarch during the American Revolutionary War?	C. George III	T2
14	Apartheid was implemented in which African country?	B. South Africa	T8
15	The Battle of Waterloo was fought on:	A. 18 June 1815	T3
16	Which of the following was not part of the British Empire?	B. Spain	G
17	The early Victorian Anglo-Russian rivalry known as the “Great Game” was:	D. None of these — it was a wider geopolitical rivalry in Central Asia	T6
18	The League of Augsburg was signed in:	D. None of these — the League was formed in 1686	T1
19	Who was the longest-reigning Hanoverian monarch?	D. None of these — Queen Victoria	T5
20	King Edward VIII announced his abdication from the British throne on:	C. 11 December 1936	T7

2025 objective paper

#	Stem	Keyed answer	Topic
1	What key document affirmed parliamentary supremacy after the Glorious Revolution?	B. Bill of Rights	T1
2	Which dynasty came to power after the Glorious Revolution?	D. None of these — William III of Orange and Mary II (a Stuart) reigned jointly; the Hanoverians began in 1714	T1
3	What was the primary cause of the Jacobite rebellions?	D. None of these — the central issue was the Stuart dynastic claim, intertwined with religion	T2
4	Which issue most directly led to the American War of Independence?	B. Taxation	T2
5	The Act of Union between England and Scotland was passed in:	B. 1707	T1
6	Which religious movement emphasised personal piety and social reform?	C. Methodism	T4
7	What was the main political demand of the Chartists?	B. Universal male suffrage	T4
8	Which Prime Minister repealed the Corn Laws?	C. Robert Peel	T5
9	Which monarch gave the Edwardian era its name?	C. Edward VII	T7
10	Which economic policy dominated Victorian Britain?	B. Free trade	T5
11	Which British Prime Minister made the “Iron Curtain” speech famous after Winston Churchill used the term?	D. None of these — Winston Churchill himself delivered the famous 1946 Fulton speech	T8
12	What was Britain's policy toward Nazi Germany in the late 1930s called?	C. Appeasement	T7
13	What is the process by which former colonies gained independence called?	C. Decolonization	T8
14	Which Prime Minister is most closely associated with large-scale privatisation of British industries?	A. Margaret Thatcher	T9
15	Which party governed under Tony Blair?	B. Labour Party	T10
16	What was the codename for the Dunkirk evacuation?	B. Operation Dynamo	T8
17	What was the German bombing campaign against Britain during World War II called?	A. The Blitz	T8
18	The global economic downturn beginning in 2008 is generally called the:	B. Financial Crisis	T10
19	Which group led the major 1984–85 industrial action?	A. Miners	T9
20	David Cameron formed which type of government in 2010?	B. Coalition government	T10

2026 objective paper

#	Stem	Keyed answer	Topic
1	Which monarch ruled jointly with William III after 1689?	D. None of these — Mary II	T1
2	The Act of Settlement 1701 secured the crown for which house?	A. Hanover	T1
3	The Seven Years' War established British dominance over:	C. French North America	T2
4	Who was Prime Minister during the American Declaration of Independence?	B. Lord North	T2
5	The Act of Union 1801 created the United Kingdom of:	C. Great Britain and Ireland	T3
6	The Peterloo Massacre occurred in which city?	D. None of these — Manchester	T5
7	The Irish Famine was chiefly caused by the failure of which crop?	C. Potato	T5
8	Women over the age of 30 first gained the parliamentary vote in:	D. None of these — 1918	T5
9	Who was Prime Minister during the Winter of Discontent?	B. James Callaghan	T8
10	Britain's first female Prime Minister belonged to which party?	C. Conservative	T9
11	The Good Friday Agreement addressed conflict in:	B. Northern Ireland	T10
12	The London 7/7 bombings occurred in:	D. None of these — 2005	T10
13	The 2010 coalition government joined the Conservatives with:	C. Liberal Democrats	T10
14	The American War of Independence ended with the:	A. Treaty of Paris 1783	T2
15	The French Revolution led to Britain:	D. None of these — revolutionary France declared war on Great Britain on 1 February 1793	T3
16	The Reform Act 1832 extended political representation mainly to:	C. Middle-class men	T5
17	The Crimean War was fought by Britain against:	A. Russia	T6
18	The policy of appeasement is most closely associated with:	B. Neville Chamberlain	T7
19	The Suez Crisis resulted in:	A. British withdrawal	T8
20	The 2010–15 coalition government was led by:	A. David Cameron	T10

Appendix C — Sources and Editorial Note

NOTE · Sources for the record

Descriptive papers: the transcriptions in *CSS British History — Descriptive Past Papers 2015–2026* (in the BH_PP_Past Papers folder of this set), compiled from FPSC paper scans mirrored by VShyne, CSS Aspirants, PakExam, Legalversity and CSSMPT. **Objective papers:** *CSS British History — Solved Objective Papers 2015–2026* (same folder); only 2024, 2025 and 2026 are complete. **Syllabus:** FPSC, *Revised Scheme and Syllabus for CSS Competitive Examination (CE-2016 and onwards)*, pp. 44–46.

NOTE · Maps and data

The historical boundaries on the maps are drawn from the open *historical-basemaps* project (A. Ourednik) and Natural Earth; they are simplified for teaching and should not be read as exact legal borders. All counts, tables and charts in this document are computed from the tagged record, so every number can be traced back to Appendix A.

NOTE · Accuracy and currency

Facts after 2012 are stated as of September 2026. The instructions printed on the paper in the examination hall are the only authority on how many questions to attempt and from which sections.